

Nimble

A fast & tactical TTRPG



Core Rules

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Start Here

Nimble is a fast-paced, heroic fantasy TTRPG where bold choices and epic stories take center stage.

At least one player should familiarize themselves with the base rules in this book (no need for everyone to read through unless they really want to). The adventure included in the *GM's Guide* is designed to introduce the rules as you play.

If you're new to TTRPGs, use one of the pre-made heroes (included in your digital downloads or at nimbleRPG.com/start). Level 1 for all of the classes is designed to be easy to pick up, giving a small flavor of the class and introducing the rules gradually without being overwhelming. Complexity and tactical depth are layered on as you level up and progress through an adventure.

If you're experienced with RPGs, feel free to create your own hero from scratch (see "Character

Creation" on pg. 18). When building your hero, perhaps what will have the largest impact on how you interact with the world is your hero's class. Start there. Then you can flesh out other important aspects of your character's ancestry, background, and what languages you know, as well as your stats and any equipment you have. You can do these steps in any order, filling out your character sheet as you go.

Now, go start playing!

Videos, Digital Downloads, FAQ, and More

Visit nimbleRPG.com/start for everything you need to jump into the game: premade characters, step-by-step instructional videos, answers to FAQs, and other handy downloadable resources!



How to Be a Good Player

Be heroic. Create a hero eager to dive into the adventure *with* the party. Reluctant, anti-social loners can drag down everyone's fun. Your games will shine when you lean into the shared adventure.

Pay attention. Ask questions. Take notes. The more questions you ask, the more information you'll have to work with, and you'll be able to make more interesting decisions.

Be creative! Frequently, the answer to a problem isn't found on your character sheet. A hammer (or anything else) can be used in lots of ways!

Embrace failure. You shouldn't *try* to fail, but some of the best moments in a game can come from a failed roll or bad decision. Go with it!

Respect everyone else's time. Swift, suboptimal decisions are *better* than slow, optimal ones. They will tend to be more fun anyway! If you can't decide what to do on your turn, attack and pass. Think when everyone else isn't waiting on you. Also, arrive on time.

Share the spotlight. If you've been rolling or talking more than everyone else, call on your par-tymates to help you; shine the spotlight on them.

Sneaky characters shouldn't spend a bunch of time sneaking around a dungeon without the rest of the party. A charismatic hero might be taking the lead in a negotiation (that's fine!), but he may want to call on his Berserker pal for a bit of extra leverage. "Ragnar, would you like to have a word with this stubborn gentleman while the rest of us step outside?"

Treat the world realistically. If you insult (or

kill) other characters you come across, expect consequences! If you negotiate and haggle with every merchant, your reputation as penny pinchers will likely become widespread. If you do something foolish in front of a king, expect to be jailed (or worse). If you heal an ally, deal lots of damage, or always use the same tactics, expect the bad guys to catch on and adapt.

Describe your actions, not mechanics. The Game Master (GM, the player running the game) will tell you if you need to roll any dice. If your idea is good enough, you may not need to!

No: "Can I make an Examination check?"

Yes: "I want to search the books and paintings on the walls, looking for a secret door."

No: "I make an attack roll."

Yes: "I smack that goblin with my sword!"

No: "Save your reaction, I'm only at 2 Wounds, I can take three more."

Yes: "Leave me be, I can take the hit!"

Note. If these examples don't mean anything to you, that's okay, you'll get the hang of it after playing once or twice.



Be gracious to the GM. They put a lot of effort into running the game; avoid arguing over rulings. Give them a break sometimes and offer to run a session for them! **Bring snacks.**



CORE RULES

Stats

Heroes have 4 stats that impact their effectiveness in various tasks: 2 Key Stats crucial to their class and 2 Secondary Stats. The maximum a hero's stat can typically go is **+5**.



STRENGTH (STR)

Your raw physical power and resilience, endurance, and resistance to harm. Affects STR weapon damage, resistance to Wounds, HP recovery, Concentration, STR saves, carrying capacity, Grappling, and the Might skill.



DEXTERITY (DEX)

Your agility, reflexes, and precision with blades or bows. Affects DEX weapon damage, Initiative, DEX saves, Grappling, and can contribute to Defense, as well as the Stealth and Finesse skills.



INTELLIGENCE (INT)

Your Intelligence reflects knowledge and reasoning across fields like the arcane, tactics, or street smarts. Affects languages, spellcasting, use of wands, spell scrolls, INT saves, as well as the Arcana, Examination, and Lore skills.



WILL (WIL)

Your force of personality, courage, and wisdom. Will shapes your interactions with both nature and society. Affects spellcasting and WIL saves, as well as the Insight, Influence, Naturecraft, and Perception skills.

KEY. When an ability or spell references "KEY," use one of your Key Stats. If a stat is listed before a die roll, roll a number of dice equal to the stat. For example, "WIL d8" means that if your WIL is 2, you roll 2d8 (two eight-sided dice).

ARTIST: EARL LAN



Skills

Skills gauge how well your hero interacts with the world. Whenever you tell the GM what you are doing, they may ask you to use one of your skills. The maximum bonus a skill can have is **+12**.

Arcana (INT). Understanding of magical phenomena, spells, and enchantments. With Arcana, you can identify magical effects, decipher arcane symbols, and discern the properties of magical items. It also grants insights into the abilities and weaknesses of magical beings like Aberrations, Elementals, and Oozes.

Examination (INT). Aptitude for thorough analysis and deduction. Use Examination to diagnose injuries, determine causes of death, uncover clues, and unravel the workings of traps or mechanical devices. It also grants insights into the abilities and weaknesses of Constructs.

Finesse (DEX). The ability to use your hands and feet in careful ways. Use Finesse for activities such as picking locks, disarming traps, piloting vehicles, tinkering, card tricks, stealing or planting items, climbing a mossy wall, or any other task that requires precise, careful movement.

Influence (WIL). Your persuasiveness, charm, and ability to influence others through charisma or cunning. Use Influence to convince or deceive people, negotiate deals, build trust, win allies to your cause, or put on a captivating performance.

Insight (WIL). Your ability to understand people and situations beyond the obvious. Use Insight to sense motives, detect lies, read hidden emotions, make sense of clues, and when faced with uncertainty—you can think ahead or just "get" what is happening. Insight can be used to retroactively change situations:



Player: "Oh no! I forgot to buy rope back in town!"

GM: "Give me an Insight check; maybe your hero would have thought about it..."

Lore (INT). Understanding of the history of civilization, kingdoms, and religions. Use Lore to recall historical events and grasp the significance of cultural practices. It extends to knowledge of the abilities and behavior of Celestials, Dragons, Fey, Fiends, Giants, Humanoids, and Undead.

Might (STR). Your ability to apply strength effectively. Use Might for lifting heavy objects, breaking through obstacles, climbing, swimming, jumping, or performing feats of strength.

Naturecraft (WIL). Your expertise in wilderness survival, navigation, tracking, and the handling of animals. Use Naturecraft to thrive in the wild, identify flora, fauna, and track creatures with precision. It encompasses knowledge of Beasts, Monstrosities, and Plants, providing insights into their behavior, habitats, and characteristics.

Perception (WIL). Your overall ability to notice subtle details in your surroundings. Use Perception to spot hidden objects, detect secret passages, sense subtle environmental changes, and sense when you're being followed or observed. It encompasses your ability to pick up on non-obvious cues, and hidden threats.

Stealth (DEX). Your proficiency in staying unseen and moving quietly. Use Stealth to hide, slip past guards, evade detection, and move without drawing attention.



ARTIST: JUSTIN GERARD



Skill Checks & Saves

When you want to affect the *world* (convince an NPC, spot a trap, pick a lock, etc.), the GM may call for a skill check. Roll 1d20 and add your skill. If the total meets or exceeds the Difficulty Challenge (DC), you succeed; otherwise, you fail. The DC varies based on the task (a roll of **1 always fails**; a roll of **20 always succeeds**):

- **Easy:** Spotting a large Ogre crouched behind a small bush might be a **DC 8** Perception check.
- **Medium:** A hidden doorway behind a bookcase might be a **DC 12** Examination check.
- **Challenging:** Calming an injured Owlbear stuck in a trap may be a **DC 15** Naturecraft check.
- **Very Difficult:** Intuiting the true intentions of a trained Spy may be a **DC 18** Insight check.
- **Extremely Difficult:** Disarming an ancient legendary trap may be a **DC 20+** Finesse check.

SAVES

When the *world* affects you, make a save instead of a skill check. Roll 1d20 and add the relevant stat. A roll of 1 always fails, 20 always saves.

- **STR Save.** When your overall fitness and physicality is tested. STR helps resist forced movement, restraint, poison, and extreme temperatures.
- **DEX Save.** When your agility or speed is tested. DEX helps you dive for cover in an explosion or stay on your feet while running across icy terrain.
- **INT Save.** When your intelligence is tested. INT helps you see through tricks and illusions.
- **WIL Save.** When your courage or personality is tested. WIL helps you resist charm or fear effects.

HEROES & SAVES

- The DC for effects a hero causes is **10+KEY**.
- Each hero has 1 advantaged save (▲), 1 disadvantaged save (▼), and 2 neutral saves.

Example. A Berserker (STR ▲, INT ▼) would roll all of his STR saves with advantage and all of his INT saves with disadvantage (see next page).

CONCENTRATION

Some activities require Concentration to maintain. A character can only Concentrate on one activity at a time. Whenever a character is **crit** while concentrating, they must make a **DC 10 STR save** or Concentration is broken and the activity fails. Concentration is automatically broken whenever a character drops to 0 HP or is Incapacitated.

COVER

A creature mostly obscured from line of sight (standing behind a tree, a larger ally, a knocked over table, in poor lighting, etc.) has **Cover** and imposes disadvantage on attacks against them. A creature completely obscured from view has **Full Cover** and cannot typically be targeted by attacks.

HIDING

To hide in combat, you must have Cover from the creatures you are attempting to hide from and use an action to make a **DC 10 Stealth** check (if you have Full Cover, you succeed automatically).

Most creatures will not prioritize finding or attacking hidden creatures (as long as there are other dangers to deal with). The first attack you make while hidden is made with advantage (then you are no longer hidden).

Monsters Are Smart! They may catch on to heroes using the same tactics over and over again! Hiding isn't magic. If you're hiding behind a tree, and a monster looks behind the tree, you will be seen!



Advantage & Disadvantage

If you're ever in a favorable situation, the GM may allow you to roll with *advantage*: roll 1 additional die of the same type and remove the lowest. Alternatively, if the situation is unfavorable or your idea is a long shot, you may have to roll with *disadvantage* (removing the highest die instead). For multiple instances of advantage/disadvantage: roll 1 extra die for each and remove the lowest/highest.



Example 1. A shortsword (1d6) with advantage. Roll 1 additional die and remove the lowest: You hit!



Example 2. A greataxe (2d6) with disadvantage. Roll 2 additional dice, remove the 2 highest. You miss! (See attacking rules on pg. 13 for more)

Note. If there is a tie, always remove dice from left to right. 1 advantage cancels out 1 disadvantage before you roll.



Hit Points & Dying

Hit Points (HP) represent your ability to endure damage. Damage reduces your HP; when reduced to 0 HP, gain 1 Wound. You also gain the **Dying** condition until you regain HP. While Dying, your actions are limited to 1, Concentration is broken, and you are at risk of further serious harm:

- Attacking/casting spells causes **1** Wound unless you make a **DC 10 STR save**.
- Taking damage while Dying causes **2** Wounds; a crit causes **3** instead.

TEMPORARY HP

Some abilities or effects may grant temporary HP (temp HP); these are reduced first when taking damage. Temp HP do not combine: If a hero has temp HP and would gain more, they instead choose which amount to keep. They expire after a Safe Rest.

HIT DICE

Hit Dice (HD) represent your ability to recover from minor injuries. Heroes start with a max of 1 Hit Die at level 1, and this limit increases by 1 each time

they level up. Hit Dice are spent to regain HP while Resting and are recovered during a Safe Rest (see "Safe Rests" on pg. 17).

WOUNDS

Wounds are serious injuries you've taken; they are a long term gauge of how close you are to death. HP can usually be recovered quickly, but Wounds may take many days of Resting to fully recover from (usually 1/Safe Rest).

DEATH

You die when you have taken 6 Wounds (unless you have an ability that changes this number). There are ways to revive a hero who has died, but they are rare and often come at a very steep cost.

Gritty Dying Rules. For a more challenging or "old school" game reduce the max number of Wounds heroes have: 5 Wounds for slightly harder, all the way down to 2 Wounds for a very lethal game!





Movement & Size

Often play is done on a grid with 1 inch spaces (squares or hexagons), each representing roughly 5 ft. (or 1.5m). Speed is how far a creature can move at a time (typically 6 spaces). Creatures can move through ally spaces (or enemy spaces if they are at least 2 sizes bigger or smaller) as long as they don't end movement in an occupied space.

Alternate Options. Preferences for how realistic or loose play is at a table vary widely! There are alternate movement rules—with options from much more tactical and crunchy, to faster and more loose abstracted distances—in the back of this book (see “Optional Variant Rules” on pg. 54).

For size, use the following guidelines:

- **Tiny.** fits in a pocket (many can fit in 1 space).
- **Small.** fits in a backpack (2 fit in 1 space).
- **Medium.** human sized (1 fits in 1 space).
- **Large.** bear sized (1 fits in a 2×2 area).
- **Huge.** Small house sized (1 fits in a 3×3 area).
- **Gargantuan.** castle keep+ (1 fills a 4×4+ area).



GRAPPLING, RIDING, & RESTRAINED

You can attempt to grab another creature provided they are within Reach and you have at least 1 arm free (or some other way to grab them). On a failed STR or DEX save (DC 10+ your STR or DEX), a target your size or smaller is Grappled. If they are larger than you, you gain the Riding condition instead.

Ending Grapple. Forced movement (pushing a grappler away), incapacitation, or spending an action and succeeding on a STR or DEX save can end it. A grappler can move with their target at half Speed (or regular Speed if they are larger).

Restrained. Functions like Grappled, but is

caused by objects (e.g., sticky tar, chains, rope, roots) and ignores size restrictions. It can also be ended through any logical means, such as picking a lock or cutting/burning rope.



FALLING & FORCED MOVEMENT

When a character is forcibly moved but stopped by an obstacle, they take **1d6** bludgeoning damage for every space this movement is cut short. If they hit another creature, both creatures split this damage. Small, Tiny, and Flying creatures are affected by forced movement twice as much, Large creatures half as much, and Huge/Gargantuan creatures ignore it.

Falling. Falling inflicts **1d6** bludgeoning damage for every 2 spaces (10 ft./3m) fallen.



REACH, RANGE, & AOEs

Certain abilities, weapons, and spells have a specified Range, Reach, or Area of Effect (AoE), which determines who can be affected by it.

- **Reach.** Reach 1 (within 1 space) is the assumed default for all abilities unless otherwise specified.
- **Range.** If *any* enemy is adjacent to you, your Ranged attacks are made with disadvantage (Reach attacks are not so affected). You can roll with disadvantage to gain +2 Range on any Ranged attack (max +6 additional range; disadvantage 3).
- **AoE.** These attacks follow special rules to streamline play: they do not miss or crit, and a single roll is applied to all targets in the area. Ignore (dis)advantage from conditions on individual targets—such as Blind or Grappled—though anything granting you (dis)advantage still applies to your roll as normal.

Conditions

Some attacks, traps, spells, or other effects can also inflict conditions—usually negative effects other than damage. Some conditions are temporary, lasting as little as a single round; others may last until cured in some way, and some can be ended by using an action to make an appropriate save.

- **Blind.** Can't see. Attacks against you have advantage, and your attacks have disadvantage.
- **Dazed.** Heroes: lose 1 action; monsters: can perform one less action on their next turn.
- **Dying.** At 0 HP. Max 1 action. Taking damage while Dying causes 2 Wounds, a crit causes 3 instead.
- **Frightened.** Disadvantage on rolls when source of fear is near; Speed halved when moving closer to it.
- **Grappled/Restrained.** Cannot move. Attacks against you have advantage.
- **Hampered.** Any creature with actions or movement reduced (e.g., Dazed, Grappled/Restrained, Prone, Slowed, in Difficult Terrain).
- **Incapacitated.** Can't do anything. Attacks against you have advantage, and melee attacks that hit, crit.
- **Invisible.** Cannot be seen. Your attacks have advantage, and attacks against you have disadvantage.
- **Petrified.** Incapacitated with all the benefits and drawbacks of being a rock! Immune to most damage except from large explosions, picks, or similar tools.
- **Poisoned.** Disadvantage on rolls (typically, healing ends this condition).
- **Prone.** Movement costs twice as much, and disadvantage on attacks. Melee attacks against you have advantage; Ranged have disadvantage. Spend 3 spaces of your Speed to stand up.
- **Riding.** You move with the creature you are riding. Any attacks that miss you, strike them.
- **Silenced.** Cannot cast spells or use other abilities that require speaking (e.g. Commander's Orders).
- **Slowed.** Speed halved during your next turn.
- **Taunted.** Disadvantage on attacks except against the most recent taunter.

Other Minor Statuses. Minor statuses (Smoldering, Distracted, etc.) do nothing on their own and end with combat. Some spells and abilities have additional effects against such targets.



Stacking Conditions? A creature either has a condition or not (e.g., Dazed/Poisoned/Slowed). Gaining these conditions when you already have it has no additional effect (e.g., a Dazed creature that gets Dazed again does not lose an additional action, being Poisoned again does not impose additional disadvantage, being Slowed again does not further reduce Speed).

COMBAT

Heroic Actions

Heroes have **3 actions** to attack, move around the battlefield, cast spells, etc. on their turn. Generally doing any single thing in combat costs 1 action. Some very strong spells or abilities may take more time and thus cost more actions. All 3 actions recharge at the **END** of your turn, so there's no need to save them up. Spend them all on your turn and when you're done, you get them all back!



ATTACK

Any ability (or spell) that can harm an enemy is an attack. Roll the die on the attack, and deal that much damage.

- **Missing.** If you roll a 1, the attack misses and has no effect. For attacks with multiple dice, the leftmost die (the Primary Die) determines whether the attack is a hit or a miss.
- **Exploding Critical Hits.** Rolling the max on a Primary Die is a critical hit (crit). When you crit, roll the Primary Die again, and add it to the total. Repeat this every time you roll the max—there's no limit, except your luck!
- **Rushed Attacks.** Heroes can attack more than once on their turn, but these additional attacks are rushed: gaining cumulative disadvantage for each attack after the first.

Saves. For abilities that enemies must save against (e.g. Grappling), they roll with increasing advantage instead.



CAST SPELL

Casting a spell requires you to have 1 hand free (or a held spellcasting focus), the ability to speak, and may require mana as well. A spell's mana cost is equal to its spell Tier; cantrips cost no mana. **Upcasting Spells.** Some spells have a greater effect for each additional mana spent (see "Magic" on pg. 44).

Free Actions. These do not cost an action or any other resource (e.g., mana) unless otherwise specified. Heroes can do simple tasks (open an unlocked door, shout a simple phrase, drop an item, end Concentration, etc.) for free 1/turn.



MOVE

Traverse spaces up to your Speed this turn (this can be broken up with other actions). You can use multiple actions to move multiple times in one turn.

While in **Difficult Terrain** (e.g., water, mud, thick roots, climbing a cliffside), each space costs twice as much movement.



ASSESS

A great way to include creativity and role-playing in combat. Choose one of the following and then make a **DC 10** skill check to:

- **Ask a Question.** About a weakness, ability, or immediate plans of enemies, the environment, story, etc. The GM will answer honestly.
- **Create an Opening.** Change the next Primary Die rolled against a target this round 1 face higher (yes, this means that attack cannot miss and is more likely to crit as well).
- **Anticipate Danger.** Change ALL Primary Dice rolled against you 1 face lower this round (yes, this means that you cannot be crit, and attacks miss you on 1 or 2).

Which Skill To Use? Whatever skill you use must make sense based on the circumstances. For example, if you're close to an enemy, you could use *Might* to create an opening, but against an enemy that is far away, that may not make sense. Or if you want to ask a question about the weaknesses of an elemental, you'd likely use *Arcana*.

Monsters Are Smart! You cannot assess using the same skill more than once in a single encounter, as your foes adapt to your tactics. You'll need to stay creative!

Heroic Reactions

Reactions cost 1 action and are generally performed when it is **not** your turn. A hero can perform each reaction no more than 1/round, and they will start their turn with fewer actions. The reactions are:



DEFEND

Reduce incoming damage from a single attack by your Defense. Some damage may not be avoidable (e.g., psychic damage, or some areas of effect).



OPPORTUNITY ATTACK

A melee attack made *with disadvantage* against an adjacent enemy as it willingly moves away. Monsters do *not* make Opportunity Attacks, only heroes can.



INTERPOSE

If a creature within Reach 2 would be hit with an attack, you can enter their space and become the new target of the attack (they move to an adjacent space of their choice).



HELP

Allow an ally to reroll if you can reasonably explain how you could help them. The GM may require a skill check (or even disallow it) if the idea is a longshot (limit: 1 Help/roll).

Interpose AND Defend? Yes! As long as you have enough actions to spend, you can Interpose and Defend at the same time. However, you won't be able to do either reaction again until your next turn ends since each of those is limited to 1/round.

Teamwork! Help as a Heroic Reaction is a fantastic way to bring teamwork, role-playing, and creativity into a combat encounter. Did your buddy fail? Maybe not! Think quickly and see if you can help them succeed.

Monsters

MONSTER ARMOR

Most monsters are unarmored, but some tougher foes might have **Medium Armor: -5 damage** from incoming attacks, or **Heavy Armor: -10**.



Crits Ignore Monster Armor! This means against armored foes your tactics may need to change. Gaining advantage, Assessing, changing weapons, or abilities can be extremely valuable!

VULNERABILITY & RESISTANCE

Some monsters may also be **Vulnerable** (+10 damage) or **Resistant** (-10 damage) to certain kinds of attacks.

MINIONS

Minions are weak enemies that will die from any amount of damage. Their feeble attacks cannot crit, ignore advantage/disadvantage, and they attack as a group so any number of minions can be Defended against as if they were a single attack. Dealing a large amount of damage to a minion can (at the GM's discretion) overflow to other minions within range as well.



ARTIST: FORREST IMEL



Starting Combat

A combat encounter begins when the GM tells the party to "Roll Initiative!" Each hero rolls 1d20 and adds their Initiative bonus (typically their DEX). A single digit means they start combat with 1 action. 2 digits, they start combat with 2. A result of 20+ (or a natural 20) means they get all 3 actions! *Regardless of what a hero rolls on Initiative, at the end of their turn they gain all 3 actions back.*

Surprise. Occasionally a party may catch the bad guys completely off guard. So the GM may grant the party advantage on Initiative, or in extreme cases, they may not need to roll Initiative at all—the GM can allow them to start with all 3 actions!

Note. Merely being hidden or punching first is NOT sufficient to gain Surprise! If an enemy is on guard or at all aware of your presence, they cannot be surprised.

Playing virtually? You can go in webcam order, alphabetically, or however is easiest to track.

TURNS, ROUNDS, & ENCOUNTERS

A **Turn** is when a hero or group of monsters acts. A **Round** is when all creatures have taken a turn (creatures act simultaneously "in-world" so Rounds and Turns both take roughly 6 seconds). An **Encounter** is all of the rounds in a particular combat.

1/Turn Abilities. If you perform one on your turn, and can find a way to perform it on another creature's turn, you can do it again (e.g., Sneak Attack combined with Opportunity Attack or Coordinated Strike!).

1/Round Abilities. These reset whenever your own turn ends (e.g., when you Defend, you cannot do so again until your next turn ends).

If the heroes are surprised, they may have to roll with disadvantage. Or, in extreme cases, the heroes may automatically start combat with only 1 action, or the monsters may go first also!

TURN ORDER

When combat begins, by default, the heroes go first. Whichever player is ready first goes first (or whoever makes the most sense story-wise), with play proceeding around the table clockwise.

Monsters will typically act last, though some monsters may be fast enough to act sooner in the round. A monster (or monster group) should act at the same time each round.

Encourage teamwork, be flexible. If players want to strategically switch their turns for one round to facilitate teamwork or execute a tactical plan, the GM can allow this at his/her discretion. This should be done only occasionally, though, to avoid slowing the game down or losing track of who has taken their turn.

ACTING OVER MULTIPLE TURNS

For activities that cost more than 1 action, your actions can be spent over multiple turns in combat as long as Concentration is maintained and you do not perform other actions or reactions in the meantime (unless they are free).

Example. Book, the Mage, wants to cast Glacier Strike (3 actions), but only has 1 action left. He'll spend 1 action on this turn to start casting the spell, and on his next turn spend 2 more to finish casting it. He's taking a risk, though: he can't Defend himself and may need to rely on his party to protect him!

ARTIST: VLAD IFTIMESCU



RESTING & DOWNTIME



Field Rests

While out adventuring, heroes can take Field Rests to regain HP.

- **Catch Breath.** Requires at least 10 minutes to tend to your injuries. Expend any number of Hit Dice one at a time (roll them and add your STR to each), and regain that many HP.
- **Make Camp.** If you Rest for at least 8 hours with food and sleep, take the max value for each Hit Die you expend instead of rolling. Add your STR to each Hit Die as usual.

***What if I Have Negative STR?** Your frail body doesn't recover as quickly as others. Subtract your STR from each HD you expend!*



Safe Rests

Safe Rests take place in a safe location designated by your GM, typically lodging at an inn overnight—but could also be at a secret oasis, a well-stocked cabin in the woods, near a sacred shrine, or the like. Camping in the open wilderness or in a dungeon is **not** sufficient for gaining the benefits of a Safe Rest.

After a Safe Rest, heroes recover all of their HP, Hit Dice, mana (and other class-specific resources), and heal 1 Wound. Safe Rests are a great opportunity for downtime activities as well.

***Rest for HOW Long?!** If your table prefers to largely skip downtime activities and narrate past a week of Resting, that's okay too! For a more realistic convalescence time, 1 week/Wound recovered may make more sense.*

Lodging & Downtime

Lodging. The cheapest rooms at an inn can save you money but may lead to complications. On the other hand, some inns may allow you to pay a premium for a nicer room and amenities, giving you a Temporary Boon. Typical prices (each person/day): Poor (5 sp), Comfortable (2 gp), and Lavish (10 gp). Lavish inns allow players to gain a Temporary Boon the following day (see *Lodging Boons* table on pg. 22 of the *GM's Guide*).

Downtime. The time you aren't out adventuring is called downtime. You can spend downtime to recuperate from your adventures and partake in downtime Activities. Not every moment of Downtime needs to be narrated or roleplayed. Much Downtime can be skipped over to get back to adventuring if desired. **Example Downtime Activities:**

- **Research.** Investigate a mystery, study ancient texts, or uncover hidden knowledge.
- **Retrain.** Spend time doing activities to retrain any of your chosen abilities, features, or if it makes sense in the story, possibly even your subclass.

- **Gather Information.** Meet NPCs, pick up news, or collect rumors and job leads.
- **Personal Goals.** Pursue goals from your backstory or other smaller quests you've chosen.
- **Buy & Sell.** Get new equipment, and sell treasures you've collected while out adventuring.
- **Perform.** Play music, tell stories, compete, or perform in public to earn gold or fame.
- **Craft.** Create weapons, armor, or simple items using materials you've acquired.
- **Socialize.** Build alliances, make new friends, or make new enemies.
- **Invest.** Use your gold to invest in businesses or trade ventures for future profit.
- **Mentor.** Teach another hero or NPC.
- **Serve.** Aid a patron or a deity in exchange for a favor, or perform charity for townsfolk.
- **Build.** Establish a home base, start a business, craft siege weapons, or build anything else you can imagine (GM and setting-permitting, of course).



CHARACTER CREATION



Making A Hero

Your hero is how you will make your mark on the world. Here's how you can make your own hero:

Step 1: Choose Your Class. This will have the largest impact on the other character choices you make and how you interact with the world. The core hero classes are:

- **BERSERKER.** An unstoppable force of wrath and ruin.
- **THE CHEAT.** Sneaky, backstabbing, dirty-fighting rogue.
- **COMMANDER.** A battlefield tactician, leader, and weapon master.
- **HUNTER.** Resourceful survivalist, bow master, and skilled tracker.
- **MAGE.** Wield and shape the elements of fire, ice, and lightning.
- **OATHSWORN.** Faithful guardian and avenger of the weak.
- **SHADOWMANCER.** Summon hordes of expendable minions.
- **SHEPHERD.** Master life and death. Lead a faithful companion.
- **SONGWEAVER.** Inspiring presence, sharp wit, sharper tongue.
- **STORMSHIFTER.** Master of weather, beast, and nature.
- **ZEPHYR.** A disciplined martial artist with swift hands and swift feet.

Step 2: Choose Your Ancestry & Background (and optionally, choose your adventuring motivation). What made your hero want to start adventuring? How do you know the other heroes?

Step 3: Fill in Your Character Sheet. This handy sheet of paper helps you track your stats, abilities, loot, and other important game info (see "The Character Sheet" on pg. 20).

1 HERO NAME

ANCESTRY & CLASS

HP (CURRENT/MAX)

LEVEL

SPEED

SIZE

STR DEX INT WIL

TEMP HP DEFENSE RESOURCE INITIATIVE HIT DICE WOUNDS

2 ARCANAS EXAMINATION FINESSE INFLUENCE INSIGHT LORE MIGHT NATURCRAFT PERCEPTION STEALTH

HERO ABILITIES

6 **7**

ITEMS & EQUIPMENT

4

EQUIPMENT SLOTS (10 + STR)

5

The Character Sheet

1. BASIC DETAILS & STATS

Fill in your character details: Name, Ancestry, Class, Level, Speed, and Size. Fill in the arrow for your advantaged (▲) and disadvantaged (▼) saves, and choose a stat array (place the highest numbers in the KEY stats for your class).

- **Standard:** +2, +2, +0, -1
- **Balanced:** +2, +1, +1, +0
- **Min-Max:** +3, +1, -1, -1

Example. The Cheat has DEX and INT as their KEY stats. With the Min-Max array, you might put +3 in DEX, +1 in INT, and -1 in WIL and STR. You'd also mark ▲ for DEX saves and ▼ for WIL saves.

2. SKILL POINTS

At level 1, mark your stat bonuses into each of your respective skills, then place **4** additional skill points wherever you like.

Example. If you have +1 INT; mark +1 for Arcana, Examination, and Lore. Repeat for your other stats. Then, with your 4 extra points, you could increase Stealth and Finesse by +2 each; any 4 skills by 1; or dump all 4 points into a single skill. Up to you!

3. SECONDARY STATS

Mark your HP, Hit Dice size (see your class), Hit Die amount (default: LVL), Initiative (default: DEX), Size, Speed (default: 6), max Wounds (default: 6), and inventory slots (10 + STR).

4. EQUIPMENT & MONEY

Heroes start at level 1 with the equipment listed for their class and background OR **50 gp** to buy their starting equipment. If starting at a higher level, multiply that by the level you are starting at.

But my character is a wealthy noble! That's fine, but your character only has access to this amount of gold for now. Why your wealth is currently inaccessible is up to you and your GM; unlocking your full riches could be a great quest!

5. INVENTORY SLOTS

Each hero has **10 + STR** inventory slots for carrying equipment and loot (held, worn, or in a pack).

- 1 slot can hold a 1-handed weapon, shield, worn armor, stack of javelins, 500 gp, or 2 potions.
- 2 slots can hold a 2-handed weapon, unworn armor, or similarly bulky items.
- Small, related items can be grouped into one slot for simplicity (e.g., Camping Supplies: soap, blanket, brush, rations).

On Ammunition. In most games, there's no need to track ammo. If you have a quiver, you have enough arrows. Assume the hero collects fired arrows, crafts more, or buys them in town.

Alternatively, your GM may allow you to carry what you want without the bookkeeping, so long as you're reasonable!

6. LANGUAGES

All heroes speak Common by default. Each point of INT grants you an additional language known. These languages are typically spoken by:

- **Common.** Most intelligent creatures.
- **Dwarvish.** Dwarves, Gnomes, and Giants.
- **Elvish.** Elves, Fey, and Sylvan.
- **Goblin.** Goblins and Orcs.
- **Infernal.** Various Fiends and cultists.
- **Thieves' Cant.** Scoundrels and rogues.
- **Celestial.** Celestials and priests.
- **Draconic.** Dragons, Dragonborn, and Kobolds.
- **Primordial.** Elementals and Ancient Beings.
- **Deep Speak.** Underworld dwellers.

GROFWINT DRAZLON! Being heavily armed without the ability to communicate often leads to hostility—speaking another creature's language can open doors that weapons alone may not.

7. OTHER ABILITIES

Mark any other special abilities you get from your class, ancestry, background, etc.

Leveling Up

The GM may allow you to gain a level (LVL) while Safe Resting after you complete an appropriately challenging quest or adventure. At level 1, this may be as simple as clearing some angry rats out of a basement or rescuing someone from the woods. Each subsequent level will generally take more effort (and therefore more time). When you gain a level:

- **HP Increase.** Roll your Hit Die with advantage and increase your max HP by that much (or you may take the average instead: Hit Die size: d4: +3 HP; d6: +4 HP; d8: +5 HP; d10: +7 HP; d12: +8 HP).
- **More Endurance.** Your Hit Die max increases by 1 (it is typically equal to your level).
- **More Skilled.** Gain 1 skill point. Additionally, to reflect your hero's evolving expertise and priorities you may move 1 point from one skill to another (as long as the skill doesn't become negative).

Note. The maximum bonus a skill can have is +12.

- **Class Features.** Gain new class features for your level. This may mean increasing your mana pool, new spells, or even selecting a subclass!
- **Other Adjustments.** If any of your base stats increase, remember to adjust other elements of your character sheet as needed (skills, damage, Initiative, Defense, Mana, languages, etc.).





ANCESTRY & BACKGROUND



Common Ancestries

Your kin, lineage, heritage, or race—this is how your character was born and how others see you at first glance. You may be a dwarf raised in the mines under the mountain with countless other dwarves, or you may be an elf raised by goblins! It's up to you to choose how your character began. Choose 1 ancestry and add its bonus to your character sheet.

Human (Medium)

Found in every terrain and environment, their curiosity and ambition drive them to explore every corner of the world, making them a ubiquitous and versatile race.

Tenacious. +1 to all skills and Initiative.

Dwarf (Medium)

Dwarf, in the old language, means “stone.” You are resilient, solid, stout. Even when driven to exhaustion, you will not falter. Forgoing speed, you are gifted with physical vitality and a belly that can handle the finest (and worst) consumables this world has to offer.

Stout. +2 max Hit Dice, +1 max Wounds, -1 Speed. You know Dwarvish if your INT isn't negative.

Elf (Medium)

Elves epitomize swiftness and grace. Their tall, slender forms belie their innate speed, grace, and wit. Formidable in both diplomacy and combat, elves strike swiftly, often preventing the worst by acting first.

Lithe. Advantage on Initiative, +1 Speed. You know Elvish if your INT isn't negative.

***What About Half-Elves?** Mix the ancestries however makes sense in your world. You can pick one ancestral bonus and use it instead of both, or use both half as effectively or half as often.*

Halfling (Small)

Kind of like a human, but smaller (except for the feet). Where does our luck come from? Well... you know what they say about rabbit feet? Well, we've got feet for *days* compared to them. Imagine the amount of luck you could fit into *these* bad boys!

Elusive. +1 to Stealth. (1/Safe Rest) If you fail a save, you can succeed instead.

Gnome (Small)

Eccentric, curious, and perpetually optimistic, gnomes are cheerful—especially when compared to their typically grumpier and larger kin, the dwarves. Known for their tinkering, spreading cheer, and playful antics, gnomes pursue their passions with a scatterbrained enthusiasm.

Optimistic. (Free Reaction, Reach 6) Allow an ally to reroll any 1 die; resets when healed to max HP. -1 Speed. You know Dwarvish if your INT isn't negative (but you call it Gnomish, of course).

***Flavor Is Free.** Want to play a Stout Halfling instead of an Elusive one? An Optimistic Human instead of Tenacious? As long as it makes sense and the GM is on board, go for it!*



Uncommon Ancestries

Note: Your setting may or may not support these choices—check with your GM first before selecting one!

Dragonborn (Medium)

The soul of a dragon burns within you, the scales of your body are like forged steel. You are a kiln and your heritage the coals that stoke your flames. Call upon your wrath to speak in the tongue of your ancestors and imbue unbridled fury into your attacks.

Draconic Heritage. +1 Defense. (1/Safe Rest) Deal an additional LVL+KEY damage on an attack (ignoring armor) divided as you choose among any of the attack's targets (recharges whenever you gain a Wound). You know Draconic if your INT isn't negative.

Goblin (Small)

Green, cunning, and perpetually vilified, Goblins thrive on the edge of chaos. For a Goblin, vanishing into the shadows is not just a skill—it's an identity. After all, what kind of Goblin would you be if you couldn't slip away unnoticed?

Skedaddle. Can move 2 spaces for free after you become the target of an attack or negative effect (after damage, ignoring difficult terrain). You know Goblin if your INT isn't negative.

Orc (Medium)

Just when you think you've bested a mighty Orc, you've merely succeeded in rousing their anger. Engaging in combat with an Orc is no endeavor for the weak-willed. While others may cower before death's approach, Orcs boldly defy its grasp.

Relentless. (1/Safe Rest) When you would drop to 0 HP, you may set your HP to LVL instead. +1 Might. You know Goblin if your INT isn't negative (but you call it Orcish, of course).

Kobold (Small)

Small, often maniacal, and dragon-obsessed. Kobolds thrive in familial groups, working together and finding ingenious ways to survive despite their diminutive size. Underestimated by many, Kobolds prove time and again that even the smallest among us can wield great power.

Wily. Advantage on skill checks related to dragons and to Influence friendly creatures. (1/encounter) Force an enemy to reroll a non-critical attack against you. You know Draconic if your INT isn't negative.

Fiendkin (Medium)

Said to have been born from a cursed bloodline or from the union of man and fiend, Fiendkin often find themselves outcasts in society. Yet, they embody determination in the face of adversity. Their ancestors didn't emerge from the depths of the Everflame to succumb to minor setbacks!

Flameborn. 1 neutral save is advantaged instead. You know Infernal if your INT isn't negative.

Bunbun (Small)

Bunbun are agile and unpredictable, using their powerful legs to leap great distances and catch foes off guard. Facing a Bunbun means contending with an opponent who can strike from unexpected angles and swiftly reposition themselves in the heat of battle.

Bunny Legs. (1/encounter) Before Interposing or after Defending (after damage), hop up to your Speed in any direction for free.

Flavor Is Free. Want to be a leaping Frogfolk instead of a Bunbun? A Flameborn Kobold? A winged Fairy instead of a Birdfolk? A Badgerfolk instead of a Stoatling? As long as it makes sense and your GM is game, go for it!





Exotic Ancestries

Note: Your setting may or may not support these choices—check with your GM first before selecting one!

Birdfolk (*Small or Medium*)

Birdfolk find sanctuary not in stone or chains, but within the boundless expanse of the sky. However, the gift of flight comes at a cost—hollow bones, and commensurate frailty.

Hollow Bones. You can fly as long as you are wearing armor no heavier than Leather. Crits against you are Vicious (the attacker rolls 1 additional die). Forced movement moves you twice as far.

Celestial (*Medium*)

Descendants of divine beings, Celestials carry an aura of nobility and grace. Their innate connection to the higher planes allows them to resist the effects of misfortune, standing strong where others may falter.

Highborn. Your disadvantaged save is Neutral instead. You know Celestial if your INT isn't negative.

Changeling (*Medium*)

Often hunted for their silver blood, Changelings are natural survivors, slipping into new identities with ease. Changelings that shift too often typically aren't long for the world—they can struggle to remember who they once were, becoming little more than reflections of the faces they wear.

New Place, New Face. +2 Shifting Skill Points. You take on the appearance of any ancestry (transformation time 10 min). When you do, you may move your 2 Shifting Skill Points into any 1 skill.

Crystalborn (*Medium*)

Formed from living crystal, the Crystalborn are beings of dazzling beauty and otherworldly toughness. Their translucent bodies refract light and sound, granting them unique abilities in combat.

Reflective Aura. (1/encounter) When you Defend, gain KEY Defense and deal KEY damage back to the attacker (ignoring their armor).

Dryad/Shroomling (*Small or Med*)

Tied to the natural world, Dryads and Shroomlings embody the balance between flora and fauna. Their unique physiology releases toxic spores when harmed, providing a natural defense against those who dare to harm them.

Danger Pollen/Spores. Whenever you gain one or more Wounds, you excrete soporific spores: all adjacent enemies are Dazed. You know Elvish if your INT isn't negative.

Half-Giant (*Large*)

Towering beings whose strength is as immovable as the mountains they call home. Their sheer size and resilience make them fearsome opponents, capable of surviving even devastating blows.

Strength of Stone. (1/encounter) Force an enemy to reroll a crit against you. +2 Might. You know Dwarvish if your INT isn't negative (but you call it Giant, of course).

Minotaur/Beastfolk (*Medium*)

Minotaur and other Beastfolk embody a primal connection to *The Wild*, combining strength with natural agility. Their powerful build allows them to move swiftly, whether repositioning to outflank foes or charging in with unstoppable force.

Charge. When you move at least 4 spaces, you can push a creature in your path 1 space.

Oozeling/Construct (*Small or Med*)

What even is a "PeOpLe" anyway? So what if your heart pumps oil instead of blood, so what if you don't even *have* a heart!? If you can squish yourself into a pair of pants, or swing a sword like everyone else, who's to say *you* can't be a pEOpLe, too?!

Odd Constitution. Increment your Hit Dice one step (d6 » d8 » d10 » d12 » d20); they always heal



you for the maximum amount. Magical healing always heals you for the minimum amount.

Planarbeing (*Medium*)

You are not from this plane of existence—your soul is not as strongly tethered to it as others. But with this vulnerability comes power, the ability to temporarily shift from one plane to another in times of dire need.

Planeshift. -2 max Wounds. Whenever you Defend, you can gain 1 Wound to temporarily phase out of the material plane and ignore all effects of the attack.

Ratfolk (*Small*)

Ratfolk are survivors, thriving in the shadows of society where others fear to tread. Agile, resourceful, and fiercely loyal to their own, they have a knack for turning scraps into solutions.

Scurry. Gain +2 Defense if you moved on your last turn. +1 Speed.

Stoatling (*Small*)

Stoatlings may be small, but they're far from weak. With fierce determination and warrior hearts, they can take down foes many times their size. Their

agility and tenacity let them exploit larger enemies' weaknesses, turning their size into a lethal advantage.

Small But Ferocious. Whenever you make a single-target attack against a creature larger than you, roll 1 additional d6 for each size category it is larger. They do the same.

Turtlefolk/Stonefolk (*Small or Med*)

Turtlefolk and Stonefolk take their time in everything they do; they are patient, sturdy, and slow to anger. They rely on their thick shells for protection, making them difficult to harm, but their cautious movements come at the cost of Speed.

Slow & Steady. +4 Defense, -2 Speed.

Wyrdling (*Small*)

Unpredictable and chaotic, Wyrdlings are the result of magic gone awry. Their bodies pulse with raw arcane energy, and their mere presence often disturbs the balance of magic around them.

Chaotic Surge. (1/encounter) Whenever you or a willing ally within Reach 6 casts a Tiered spell, you may allow them to roll on the Chaos Table.

Backgrounds

Backgrounds provide a glimpse into your character's past—how they were raised, the skills they honed before becoming an adventurer, or even their defining personality traits. Feel free to adapt or reimagine these backgrounds to suit your character's story. **Choose 1 background:**

Back Out of Retirement. You've forgotten more than most adventurers these days know! Talk with your GM, what made you come out of retirement?

- **Let's see if I remember how to do this...** Gain 1 Wound to use an ability or cast a spell as if you were 1 level higher.

- **These old bones...** Your age has long since started to show. -1 max Wounds.

Devoted Protector. Choose 1 ally in your party. You can survive +3 max Wounds as long as they are nearby. Whenever they take a Wound, you do too.

Academy Dropout. School just isn't for everyone! You learn by experience in the *real world* (or at least that's what you tell yourself). Learn any 1 Utility Spell.

Made a BAD Choice. Start with 500 or 1000 extra gold, or an uncommon/rare magical item (that your GM allows). Gain an equally powerful curse or enemy who wants it back. *If you choose this background, your GM may allow you to choose another.*

Haunted Past. You are haunted by voices that occasionally give you cryptic advice. The voices are sometimes VERY helpful. Other times they only want to see you suffer. Advantage against fear.

Ear to the Ground. Advantage on checks to know or obtain gossip for events that will soon happen or have happened less than 1 year ago.

What? I've Been Around. (1/per location; or at the GM's discretion). You happen to know JUST the person who has the information you're looking for, or could get you out of a jam, and... Roll 1d20:

- **1-5.** They want you DEAD.
- **6-12.** You owe them money.
- **13-19.** They can be convinced to help you.
- **20.** They are your biggest fan/are madly in love with you.

Acrobat. Can be thrown by a larger ally, REALLY far. Half damage from falling and forced movement.

Wild One. Whether it is the sticks or flowers in your hair, your smell, or the way you carry yourself, wild creatures are less frightened of you and more willing to aid you. +1 Naturecraft. While Field Resting in the wild, your Hit Dice recover +KEY HP.

Fey Touched. You take half damage from all magical effects, double from weapons made of metal (before Defense is applied).

Survivalist. You never run out of your own personal rations. Anything can be food if you try hard enough! (1/Safe Rest) End poison on yourself. Advantage against poison saves. +1 max Hit Die.

Home at Sea. Recover twice as many Wounds and HP while Resting on a ship or near water. You can fill in for a first mate or captain in a pinch. Advantage on water-related skill checks.

At Home Underground. You can dig twice as fast as others. Safe Resting locations underground always count as Lavish lodging for you. You struggle to rest (INT save) while it's raining. "Water... from the SKY?!"

Raised by Goblins. You speak Goblin natively (much better than one who has learned it later in life). You automatically notice and can avoid crudely-made traps and have advantage to notice and disarm more sophisticated traps.

Change It Up! You can choose any other ancestry to be raised by instead, and exchange the known language and get 1 helpful/iconic ability those people would inculcate (e.g., Dwarves know Dwarvish and are very good with smithing or stonemasonry).

(Former) Con Artist. You can forge most documents or mimic voices flawlessly. You have a crim-

inal contact in most major cities. However, your reputation often precedes you—until you prove yourself to be trustworthy.

History Buff. Advantage on all Lore checks related to knowledge about items, facts, or events that happened more than 100 years ago.

(Secretly) Undead. Unnatural Resilience: You are immune to disease and do not need to eat, drink, or breathe. Children, animals, and Celestials are uneasy in your presence; many will be horrified to discover your true nature.

Taste for the Finer Things. You always have up-to-date knowledge of the customs and dress of the upper classes and may even know many of their secrets. Advantage on Influence checks with the upper class.

Fearless. You are immune to the Frightened condition. +1 Initiative. -1 Defense.

So Dumb I'm Smart Sometimes. Req. 0 or negative INT at character creation. (2/Safe Rest) Reroll a failed INT-related skill or Save with advantage.

Wily Underdog. Req. 0 or negative STR at character creation. (2/Safe Rest) Reroll a failed STR attack, STR save, or Might check and use another stat instead.

Bumblewise. Req. 0 or negative WIL at character creation. A result of 1 or less on any WIL-related roll counts as a natural 20 (WIL save, Naturecraft, Perception, Influence, or Insight check).

Accidental Acrobat. Req. 0 or negative DEX at character creation. Whenever you fail a DEX-related roll (e.g., DEX attack, DEX save, Stealth check, Finesse check), you may roll again. If you still fail, the consequences are BAD.

Tradesman/Artisan. Choose a profession (Baker/Cook, Smith, Stonemason, Weaver, Leatherworker, etc.). Checks you make related to that profession are made with advantage. You also retain special knowledge related to your profession.

Make It Your Own! Remember, backgrounds are just a starting point—you're free to adjust, reimagine, or completely rewrite them to suit your character's story. If you want to know a Utility Spell but don't like the Academy Dropout flavor, come up with a different reason why your character might know it. Maybe they learned it from a traveling bard or discovered it etched into an ancient relic.

Feel free to swap traits, change the flavor text, or blend backgrounds together. Haunted Past might become Blessed by Spirits if your character views their otherworldly voices as guardians rather than tormentors.

Work with your GM to ensure any changes align with your game's setting and are balanced with other backgrounds. These are here to inspire creativity—what you build with them is entirely up to you!





ADVENTURING MOTIVATION



Adventuring Motivation

The world is a dangerous place—people don't usually just "go adventuring" without a reason. Your motivation should make your character want to work with the rest of the group. **Choose 1:**

I owe a life debt to someone in my party.

Chat with your party: Who else needs help with their backstory? What did they do to help you?

I owe a LOT of money to some very dangerous people. What did you do with the money? Your GM probably has some GREAT ideas of bad guys you're in deep with.

I need to grow in power to defeat someone who has wronged me. Do you know who wronged you, or are they unknown? Is it an individual or a larger group? Chat with your GM; they'll love to help fill in the blanks.

I am searching for a way to bring a loved one (or someone I hate) back from the dead. Who even told you this was possible? What if they don't remember you?

I am trying to get back home. Where is home for you, do you even remember? What caused you to leave? Chat with your GM; they can give you some options of homelands.

I am searching for the one who stole something valuable from me. Is it an object? A person? A memory? Was it really stolen or did you make a bad bargain?

I was polymorphed into another kind of creature by a wizard. Hah! How would it feel for a cute halfling to become an ugly goblin? What did you do to anger the wizard?

Duty calls. I am honor-bound to serve. Who calls you? Your king? Your family? An ancient alliance or grudge? Talk with your GM and other players for ideas and mutual connections.

I was best friends with (and betrayed by) _____. Do you want to win them back? Get even? Warn others of their backstabbing? Talk with your GM about who this might be.

I'm lost. Physically? Emotionally? Spiritually? Are you in the wrong country or even plane of existence?

Wanderlust/Pilgrimage. What amazing thing do you want to see or experience? Have you spent too much time away from the road? Your GM probably has some fantastic locations in mind for you.

My home town is in danger. Are you looking for a cure? Mercenaries? Personal strength?

Curiosity! I want to learn the DEEP secrets. Which secrets? Magical, lore, politics, what really happened in history?

To prove my worth. You were always underestimated—by your family, your village, your peers, or yourself. What will it take to show them you're more than they thought? What kind of recognition do you seek?

I'm following a prophecy. A mysterious figure or ancient text foretold that you would play a crucial role in the fate of the world. What do you know of the prophecy? Do you believe it?

Or Make Your Own! A great character background has connections with the world, its people, your fellow heroes, or even the bad guys. Work with your GM and fellow players to find a motivation that will cross paths with where the story goes. Every good hero has a desire. What's yours?

ADVENTURING EQUIPMENT



Equipment

Equipment Proficiency. Heroes can use any equipment they like; however, each class has a list of weapons and armor types they are most skilled with. Weapons used without proficiency cannot crit. Defending while wearing armor without proficiency costs 1 additional action.

Swapping Equipment. A hero can sheathe weapons or shields they are proficient with and equip a different one for free 1/round.

ARMOR & DEFENSE

Defense represents your hero's ability to dodge or block damage when you use the Defend reaction. While unarmored or wearing regular clothes, your Defense is equal to your **DEX**. Some items may grant additional Defense while equipped.



Defend Yourself! If you're standing right next to a baddie with an axe and you're not doing anything to defend yourself, chances are, you're going to get axed (see "Defend" on pg. 14)!

CLOTH	DEFENSE	COST	MAIL	DEFENSE	COST
Adventurer's Garb	2+DEX	10 gp	Rusty Mail	6+DEX (max 2)	15 gp
Minor Enchantment	3+DEX	100 gp	Chain Shirt (Req. 2 STR)	9+DEX (max 2)	60 gp
Major Enchantment	4+DEX	1,000 gp	Scale Mail (Req. 3 STR)	12+DEX (max 2)	700 gp
Epic Enchantment	5+DEX	10,000 gp	Dragonscale (Req. 4 STR)	15+DEX (max 2)	3,000 gp
LEATHER	DEFENSE	COST	PLATE	DEFENSE	COST
Cheap Hides	3+DEX	5 gp	Rusty Plate (Req. 2 STR)	10	25 gp
Ox Hide	4+DEX	45 gp	Half Plate (Req. 3 STR)	14	200 gp
Hard Leather (Req. 1 STR)	5+DEX	300 gp	Full Plate (Req. 4 STR)	18	2,000 gp
Wyrmhide (Req. 1 STR)	6+DEX	2,000 gp	Adamantine Plate (Req. 5 STR)	22	5,000 gp
SHIELDS	DEFENSE	COST	DEFLECT! An optional rule for additional defensive flexibility: instead of adding your shield's Defense to your total as normal, you may reduce the damage of an attack by your shield's Defense value for free (1/round). 		
Wooden Buckler	2	5 gp			
Iron Shield (Req. 2 STR)	4	80 gp			
Tower Shield (Req. 3 STR)	6	1,500 gp			
Dragon Shield (Req. 3 STR)	8	9,000 gp			

WEAPON PROPERTIES

- **2-handed.** Can be held in a single hand, but must be wielded in 2 hands to attack with it.
- **Load.** Some weapons require extra actions to load before each shot.
- **Reach.** How close an enemy must be to be affected by this attack. If unspecified, Reach 1.
- **Range.** Attacks can be made from afar. If *any* enemy is adjacent to you, your Ranged attacks are made with disadvantage. Add 1 die of disadvantage to gain +2 Range (max +6 additional Range; disadvantage 3).
- **Thrown.** Treat a melee weapon as if it had Range. Once thrown, you no longer have it!
- **Vicious.** Roll 1 additional die whenever you roll crit damage.

Remember! Only the Primary Die (the leftmost one) is used for determining whether an attack crits. Every time you roll crit damage, roll the additional Vicious die as well!

DUAL WIELDING

Heroes may wield 2 Light weapons at the same time. While dual wielding, (1/round) you may gain advantage on an attack with those weapons. You may dual wield 1-handed weapons without the Light property if your STR is 3 or greater, or 1 weapon without the Light property if your STR is 2. If completely unarmed, fists/feet can be considered dual wielded.

Dual wielding different weapons? Roll dice for both weapons and choose either result instead (the 1/round limit still applies). Attacking with advantage? Add an extra die for one of the weapons.

UNARMED STRIKES

To attack with your bare hands or feet, roll 1d4+STR. Heroes not proficient in unarmed strikes cannot crit.

IMPROVISED WEAPONS

Using an improvised weapon (e.g. a chair, a frying pan, a big rock), default to 1d4+STR or 1d6+STR. Your GM may allow you to use bigger dice or other properties if it makes sense. An improvised weapon may be likely to break after a few hits, though!

CUSTOMIZING WEAPONS

Can you re flavor a staff as a greatclub? Sure! A sai instead of a dagger? Of course! Could you pay a blacksmith to make your 3d4 Greatmaul deal 2d6 or 1d12 damage instead? Since the dice all add up to 12, it won't break the game; ask your GM! Can a blacksmith make your *Dagger* deal that much damage? No, sorry!

Melee Weapons

ITEM	DAMAGE	PROPERTIES	COST
Dagger	1d4+DEX piercing	Light, Thrown 4	3 gp
Sickle	1d4+DEX slashing	Vicious	10 gp
Club/Mace	1d6+STR bludgeoning	–	2 gp
Hand Axe	1d6+STR slashing	Thrown 4	8 gp
Spear	1d6+STR piercing	2-handed, Reach 2	10 gp
Short Sword	1d6+DEX piercing	Light	15 gp
Rapier	2d4+DEX piercing	–	60 gp
Staff	1d8+STR bludgeoning	2-handed	8 gp
Longsword	1d8+STR slashing	2-handed (1-handed: Req. 2 STR)	60 gp
Battleaxe	1d10+STR slashing	2-handed	30 gp
Pole Hammer	1d10+STR bludgeoning	2-handed, Reach 2	60 gp
Glaive	1d10+STR slashing	2-handed, Reach 2	60 gp
Great Spear	1d10+STR piercing	2-handed, Reach 2	60 gp
Greatmaul	3d4+STR bludgeoning	2-handed (Req. 2 STR)	80 gp
Greataxe	2d6+STR slashing	2-handed (Req. 2 STR)	100 gp
Greatsword	1d12+STR slashing/piercing	2-handed (Req. 2 STR)	120 gp



Ranged Weapons

ITEM	DAMAGE	PROPERTIES	COST
Sling	1d4+DEX bludgeoning	2-handed, Range 12, Vicious	4 gp
Javelins	1d6+STR piercing	Range 8, Stack of 4	20 gp
Throwing Hammers	1d8+STR bludgeoning	Range 4, Stack of 3	25 gp
Shortbow	1d6+DEX piercing	2-handed, Range 12	25 gp
Longbow	1d8+DEX piercing	2-handed, Range 16 (Req. 1 STR)	30 gp
Crossbow	4d4+DEX piercing	2-handed, Load: 1 action, Range 8	60 gp
Handheld Ballista	1d20+DEX piercing	2-handed, Load: 2 actions, Range 8 (Req. 2 STR)	120 gp



Key Equipment



HEALING POTIONS

Healing potions are deep, shimmering red elixirs with a refreshing, effervescent taste. These potions are crucial for quick recovery, though their availability is limited. Small towns may have only a few, while cities offer more (but they are not in unlimited supply). The wealthy often use them as a display of affluence, incorporating them into elaborate mixed drinks at social events to showcase their status. Potions require one action to drink or to administer to an adjacent willing creature.



TORCHES & LANTERNS

Heroes cannot see in the dark so they are Blind while fighting in the dark. Heroes can bring a lantern or torch to light their way in the dark as long as they have a hand free (or some other way) to hold it. A torch typically lasts for 1 dungeon (or 1 level of a very large one). An oil lamp can typically last for 1 entire outing, until your

next Safe Rest. Both cast light up to **6 spaces** away; beyond this is darkness.

Be Warned! Denizens of the dark may not appreciate the light and may attack the light bearers first. Certain spells (e.g., Fire, Lightning, and Radiant) may cause flashes of light as well and draw unwanted attention!



EQUIPMENT AVAILABILITY

Costs for mundane items typically range from a few silver pieces to a few gold pieces. If you can find an artisan, you can commission them to create something for you—basically anything you can think of that their level of technology could support. The more ornate, the higher the price. Commissioning the creation of a special item will typically start around 50 gp and only go up from there. Smaller towns will have fewer items and artisans than larger cities.



Misc Adventuring Equipment

ITEM	PROPERTIES	COST
Healing Potion	(action) Heal 2d4+4 HP.	50 gp
Greater Healing Potion	(action) Heal 3d6+6 HP.	150 gp
Supreme Healing Potion	(action) Heal 4d8+8 HP.	450 gp
Torch (stack of 2)	For when it's dark. 1 use each.	5 sp
Lantern & Oil	Like a torch, but not as cool (refill: 1 gp).	10 gp
Medical Kit (1 use)	Recover 1 Wound during a Field Rest.	20 gp
Vial of Pitch	Sticky, and VERY flammable.	2 gp
Rope (50 ft.)	You always need rope.	10 gp
Chain (10 ft.)	Like rope, but stronger (and heavy).	50 gp
Bucket	Also works as a hat in a pinch!	1 gp
Padlock & Key	Lock it or lose it.	3 gp
Mirror	For medusas AND spinach teeth.	4 gp
Telescope	Arrr.	10 gp
Magnifying Glass	Make the small, big.	5 gp
Chalk	Not JUST for kids.	1 sp
Shovel	Sometimes you need a hole dug.	3 gp
Pulley	Pull down, go up.	3 gp
Grappling Hook	For climbing or catching BIG fish.	4 gp
Quiver & Ammo	Don't leave home without it.	10 gp
Saw	For cutting lumber.	4 gp
Soap	Useless.	1 sp
Strange Plant	Who knows?	5 sp
Shiny Object	Worthless, but VERY pretty.	1 sp
Lock Pick	It's not mine, honest!	5 gp
Bell	For service.	2 gp
Dice	Math rocks. LOTS of fun.	5 sp
Blanket	Warm & fuzzy.	1 gp
Hunting Trap	Snap snap, don't lose a finger!	10 gp
Camping Supplies	Bedroll, rations, simple tent.	5 gp
Crowbar	It's LIKE a key.	2 gp
Pitons	Metal spikes, for sealing doors.	5 gp
Manacles	For when someone has been bad.	3 gp
Instrument	Drums, Horn, Lyre, Flute, etc.	5–50 gp
Large Sack	Like a BIG pocket.	5 sp

What About...? These are not ALL of the items available for purchase, merely a sampling. If you can think of it, you can likely buy it!

Currency is made up of Silver (sp) and Gold pieces (gp). 10 silver = 1 gold. 1 sp is roughly the cost of a humble meal; 1 gp, a sumptuous feast. Most small towns will have equipment and items worth 50 gp or less. You'll need to adventure to larger towns or cities or find a traveling merchant to purchase more valuable pieces of equipment.





WEAPON OF
MANY HANDS

ARTIST: WARMTAIL

Magical Items

Though some magical items can be purchased, most cannot. Some special shops may have a very small selection of them to purchase, but more typically these powerful items are acquired through adventuring.

Typical Costs of Magical Items

Uncommon	Typically found around levels 2-6	50-500+ gp
Rare	Typically found around levels 5-12	500-5,000+ gp
Very Rare	Typically found around levels 8-18	5,000-500,000+ gp
Legendary	Typically found around levels 15-20	1,000,000+ gp or Priceless



HARBINGER & SOVEREIGN,
ABYSSAL'S CLAIM

Weapon of Many Hands (Rarity varies)

While equipped, this weapon grants the wielder additional arms. The wielder can use the extra arms to perform any task their normal hands can do (wield equipment, Grapple, climb, etc.) but they don't allow the wielder to perform actions any faster (and these extra appendages may be horrifying to people in polite society). A weapon that grants 1 extra hand is likely to be uncommon; 4 extra hands, legendary.

Extra Arms?! Yes, you can dual wield 2-handed weapons or wear more than 1 shield, or Grapple 2 different creatures while hitting them both at the same time! Or any number of creative things, provided you have the arms to perform the task.

Harbinger & Sovereign, Abyssal's Claim (Legendary Glaives)

Set of 2 matching glaives, +4 extra arms while both are equipped.

Weapon of Animosity (Rarity varies)

Whenever you attack with this weapon, roll an additional animosity die. The weapon deals that much additional damage to your target on a hit. Whenever this weapon misses, you take that damage instead. A weapon that adds 1d4 is likely to be uncommon; 1d10 or greater, legendary.

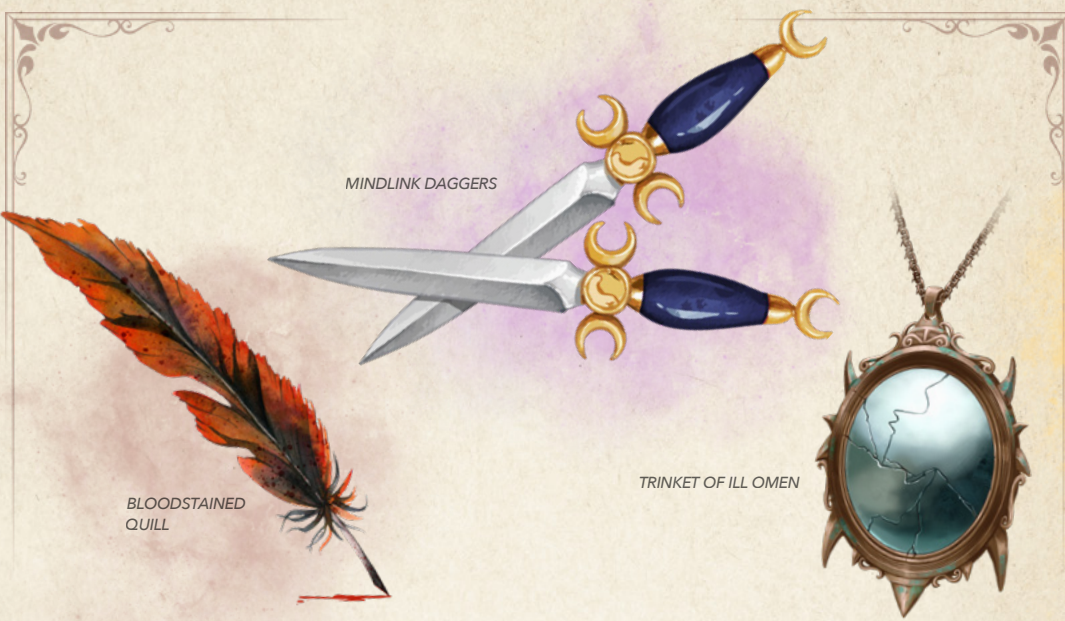
Weapon of Slaying (Rarity varies)

Whenever you attack with this weapon, it deals an additional die of damage against a particular creature type. Those creatures may try to kill you first. A 1d4 weapon of slaying is likely to be uncommon; 1d10 or more, legendary.

Gnatbane Weapon (Uncommon)

Does not miss Small or Tiny creatures (they may hate you for it and attack you first).

ARTIST: KYLE COX



Weapon of Wounding (Uncommon)

When you land a hit with this weapon, you may suffer 1d6 damage to deal twice that much additional damage to your target.

Trinket of Ill Omen (Rare)

While equipped, you have -1 to saves you roll and +1 to your save DC.

Mindlink Daggers (Rare)

A matched pair of slender, silver daggers with intertwining runes. Enables the sharing of thoughts between any who hold (or is stabbed by) one.

Bloodstained Quill (Uncommon)

If you dip this quill into the blood of a dead intelligent creature, the quill animates and writes the last words spoken by that creature.

Eyes of the Street (Uncommon)

A pair of goggles covered in muck that you can't ever clean off completely. While wearing them, you can look at a rat or a pigeon to gain the ability to see and hear through its senses for 10 minutes. Once you use this ability, you must whisper a secret to the goggles before you can use them again. That secret always seems to become a local rumor before too long....

Handwraps of Force (Rare)

While wearing these wraps, whenever you make an unarmed strike, you may push your target up to 2 spaces and yourself the same distance in the opposite direction. You may instead make an attack with no target, striking the air to propel yourself 4 spaces in any direction.

Resolute Fangs, Golden Bastion (LEGENDARY SHIELD)

+8 Defense. **Reaction:** When you reduce damage from a melee attack with this shield, it may Grapple the attacker regardless of its size (escape DC 20 STR, max 1 creature). **Action:** Speak this shield's command word to make it immovable, fixed in place, until it is spoken again.

Key of Doors (Very Rare)

Insert this key into any locked door to open it, not to the room beyond, but to any doorway you've previously walked through while holding this item.

Grim Coronet (Rare)

When you would die while wearing this crown, gain 3 actions and take a turn immediately. You die at the end of your turn.



Vindication (Legendary Weapon of Animosity)

A jagged blade marred by scorch marks and dark stains, radiating a bitter, vengeful energy that punishes both wielder and foe alike. +1d12 damage. You take this damage on a miss.

Pocket Cauldron (Rare)

While Safe Resting, use this to brew your choice of 1 potion, to be consumed immediately:

- **Elixir of Futuresight:** This potion grants the drinker a brief, cryptic vision of a future event.
- **Elixir of Requiem:** This potion allows the drinker to relive a crucial memory from their past.
- **Elixir of Time:** Once every 100 years, the cauldron can brew a potion that can take the drinker back in time 1 day.

Phoenix Helm (Legendary)

If you die while wearing this golden helm, your body explodes in flames and hot ash. You rise anew from the ashes... (see pg. 19 of the *GM's Guide* for more).

Ball of Spiders (Uncommon)

A black, palm-sized ball with faintly writhing patterns etched into its surface. **Action:** Throw this ball up to 6 spaces. Upon impact, it shatters, releasing a

swarm of harmless but horrifyingly realistic spectral spiders that cover a 2×2 area. Creatures in the area must make a WIL save or be Frightened until the end of their next turn. Once used, the ball reforms at the next Safe Rest.

Skitter Shoes (Rare)

While wearing these shoes, you can walk on vertical surfaces or ceilings as if they were flat ground, but only at half your normal Speed. If you end your turn upside down or on a vertical surface, you must make a DC 10 STR save or fall down, landing Prone.

Button of Protection (Rare)

A small, unassuming button etched with a faintly glowing sigil. When sewn onto an outfit, as a reaction when you are attacked, you may pull the button off and throw it into the air. The button emits a sudden, dazzling flash of light and a high-pitched whistle. The attacker must make a WIL save or be distracted, causing the attack to miss you.

After use, the button becomes inert. It can be sewn back onto a garment during a Safe Rest by an experienced seamstress or tailor with silver thread, which reactivates its power.

Spell Scrolls & Wands

Spell Scrolls

Spell scrolls are single-use inscribed magical spells (see "Magic" on pg. 44). Casting a spell with a spell scroll does not cost mana, nor does it require magical ability. Anyone who can read the language the scroll is written in can utilize it. Reading one aloud takes the same number of actions the spell normally takes and consumes the scroll.

A character must succeed on a **DC 10 Arcana** check to cast it successfully if they do not already know a spell from that school; on a failure, it is wasted. Spell Tier and typical price:

SPELL TIER	COST	SPELL TIER	COST
Cantrip	10 gp	Tier 5 Spell	3,000 gp
Tier 1 Spell	35 gp	Tier 6 Spell	10,000 gp
Tier 2 Spell	100 gp	Tier 7 Spell	25,000+ gp
Tier 3 Spell	300 gp	Tier 8 Spell	75,000+ gp
Tier 4 Spell	1,000 gp	Tier 9 Spell	200,000+ gp

Wands

Like spell scrolls, these can be used to cast spells without consuming mana and do not require magical ability. Unlike spell scrolls, wands can be recharged and used again. Characters proficient with wands can use one from any spell school, spending only the normal amount of actions to cast the spell.

Characters not proficient with wands must succeed on a **DC 10+spell Tier Arcana** check to successfully cast the spell. Success or failure, the charge is spent. Typical wand prices and examples:

SPELL TIER	COST	SPELL TIER	COST
Cantrip	50 gp	Tier 5 Spell	15,000 gp
Tier 1 Spell	175 gp	Tier 6 Spell	50,000 gp
Tier 2 Spell	500 gp	Tier 7 Spell	125,000+ gp
Tier 3 Spell	1,500 gp	Tier 8 Spell	375,000+ gp
Tier 4 Spell	5,000 gp	Tier 9 Spell	1,000,000+ gp



Wand of Fire Step

Uncommon wand, Cantrip (3 charges)

Recharge: Heat the wand in a blacksmith's forge until it glows, then quench it in oil.

Wand of Dread Visage

Uncommon wand, Tier 2 (2 charges)

Recharge: Place the wand in a freshly slain corpse. Leave it until only bones remain.

Wand of Fly

Uncommon wand, Tier 3 (2 charges)

Recharge: Give it to a wild bird and let it fly freely. Retrieve it wherever the bird drops it.

Wand of Glacier Strike

Very Rare wand, Tier 8 (1 charge)

Recharge: Leave the wand at the bottom of a lake until it freezes over and thaws naturally.

Wand of Ride the Lightning

Very Rare wand, Tier 6 (2 charges)

Recharge: Place at the highest point within 1 mile. Retrieve after 3 thunderstorms.

Wand of Barrier of Wind

Rare wand, Tier 2 (3 charges)

Recharge: Hang the wand with wind chimes in a breezy area. Let it ring for 3 days.

Wand of Sacrifice

Very Rare wand, Tier 6 (1 charge)

Recharge: Plant it in a new garden, leave it undisturbed until the flowers bloom.

Elderwyrms' Majesty

Legendary wand, Tier 9 (1 charge)

This wand can cast Dragonform, turning into the type of dragon that last charged it.

Recharge: Give an ancient dragon a gift that it truly desires.

Heartwood, Splinter of the Tree of Life

Legendary wand, Tier 9 (1 charge)

Cast Redeem with no required components.

Recharge: A sacred hymn must be sung over it ceaselessly for 100 years.



MAGIC

There are 6 core schools of magic. Each school has its own basic spells called *cantrips* and 9 Tiers of progressively more powerful spells that can be unlocked as heroes level up. Heroes can cast any spell from the schools that they know within the Tiers they have unlocked.

Mana. Powerful Tiered spells require mana—a portion of the spellcaster's life force—to fuel them. A spell's mana cost is equal to its Tier. Heroes gain mana as they level up. Cantrips cost no mana.

Half on Save. This means that creatures who save take half as much damage and suffer no other effects. Remember, a hero's save DC is typically 10+KEY.



Fire Spells. Deal high, consistent damage at medium range. Some fire spells can inflict the Smoldering condition and gain additional destructive effects against Smoldering enemies.



Ice Spells. Deal medium damage at long range, with a focus on controlling the battlefield and protecting the spellcaster. Some ice spells have additional effects against Hampered targets.



Lightning Spells. Deal high damage at long range with a focus on teleporting around the battlefield and taking advantage of creatures equipped with metal. However, some lightning spells may fail to find ground and damage the spellcaster instead.



Necrotic Spells. Summon horrible minions or manipulate and trap targets. Some risky necrotic spells prey upon damaged creatures, sapping their very life force—but frequently fail to distinguish between friend and foe.



Radiant Spells. Can obliterate the unholy, the fearful, and those who would dare harm you or your allies. Equally effective at a distance or in melee. Other spells can protect, mend Wounds, and even restore creatures back to life!



Wind Spells. Aid in moving friend and foe alike around the battlefield. They can also slice and cut through entire groups of foes and viciously deal extra damage on critical hits.

Secret Spells. Some spells (or even entire spell schools) have been hidden or lost through the ages. Whether they are too dangerous or for other reasons, adventurers can sometimes stumble upon new spells (or wrench them out of the undead hands of a defeated Lich).

Upcasting. You can spend additional mana on Tiered spells to make them stronger for each additional mana spent (up to the Tier that you have unlocked). For example, a character that has Tier 3 spells unlocked can upcast a Tier 1 or 2 spell at Tier 3 by spending 3 mana on them.



Range and Reach. As with weapons, spells with "Range" can target from a distance, but are cast with disadvantage if ANY enemy is adjacent to you. Add 1 die of disadvantage to gain +2 Range (max +6). Spells with "Reach" can't do this, but they are cast as normal even when in melee.



Fire Spells

CANTRIP

FLAME DART 1 ACTION

RANGE: 8. **DAMAGE:** 1d10. On crit: Smoldering.

HIGH LEVELS: +5 damage every 5 levels.

SMOLDERING. This condition does nothing on its own, though some spells and abilities have additional effects against Smoldering creatures, ending the condition.

CANTRIP

HEART'S FIRE 1 ACTION

RANGE: 4. (1/round) Give an ally 1 action. Cast as a Reaction for 1 mana.

HIGH LEVELS: +2 Range every 5 levels.

TIER 1

IGNITE 2 ACTIONS

RANGE: 8. **DAMAGE:** 4d10 to a Smoldering target.

UPCAST: +10 damage.

TIER 2

ENCHANT WEAPON 1 ACTION

CONCENTRATION: Up to 1 min. **REACH:** 8. A weapon you choose gains +KEY damage and inflicts Smoldering on crit.

UPCAST: +KEY damage.

TIER 3, AOE

FLAME BARRIER 0 ACTIONS

Castable only while Defending.

REACH: 1, AoE. **DAMAGE:** KEY and Smoldering. Triggers whenever you are attacked in melee this round.

UPCAST: +KEY damage OR +1 Reach.

TIER 4, AOE

PYROCLASM 2 ACTIONS

REACH: 3, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 2d20+10 to others on a failed DEX save (Smoldering creatures fail); half on save.

UPCAST: Advantage 1, +1 Reach.

TIER 5, AOE

FIERY EMBRACE 2 ACTIONS

CONCENTRATION: Up to 1 min. **REACH:** 8, AoE. An ally gains the effects of Enchant Weapon. Enemies gain Smoldering, lose damage resistance, and damage immunity is reduced to resistance.

UPCAST: +1 ally, +2 Reach

TIER 7

LIVING INFERNO 3 ACTIONS

Gain the effects of Flame Barrier until your next turn. At the end of this turn and your next turn, cast Pyroclasm for free.

UPCAST: Upcast Flame Barrier and Pyroclasm.

TIER 9

DRAGONFORM 5 ACTIONS

Transform into a Huge dragon. Gain 3 actions, a fly Speed of 12, LVL Defense, 10×LVL temp HP, and:

- **TOOTH & CLAW. 1 ACTION:** (Reach 2) 1d20+LVL damage (ignoring armor). Inflicts Smoldering.
- **IMMOLATING BREATH. 2 ACTIONS:** Cone 8, AoE. KEY d20 damage, half on save (Smoldering targets fail).

NOTE. You can maintain this form for as long as the temp HP granted by this spell remain (max. 10 min). When it ends, you drop to 0 HP.



Ice Spells

CANTRIP

ICE LANCE 1 ACTION

RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 1d6 cold/piercing, Slowed.

HIGH LEVELS: +3 damage every 5 levels.

CANTRIP

SNOWBLIND 1 ACTION

REACH: 1. **DAMAGE:** 1d6, Blind until the end of their next turn.

HIGH LEVELS: +3 damage every 5 levels.

TIER 1

FROST SHIELD 0 ACTIONS

Castable only while Defending.

Gain 2×KEY temp HP. The temp HP are lost at the start of your next turn.

UPCAST: +2×KEY temp HP.

TIER 2

SHATTER 2 ACTIONS

RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 3d6. ANY die can crit vs a Hampered target. On crit: +20 damage (instead of rolling any additional dice).

UPCAST: Increase a die roll by 1. +5 damage on crit.

HAMPERED. A creature with actions or movement reduced (e.g., Dazed, Slowed, Grappled, Restrained, Prone, Difficult Terrain).

TIER 3, AOE

CRYOSLEEP 2 ACTIONS

REACH: 12, 2×2 AoE. Incapacitate creatures on a failed WIL save for 2 of their turns (damage wakes them). On save, Dazed instead.

UPCAST: +1 area, +1 turn asleep.

TIER 4, AOE

RIMEBLADES 3 ACTIONS

REACH: 12, AoE. **CONCENTRATION:** Up to 1 min. Conjure icy blades in 5 contiguous spaces; this area is difficult terrain. Creatures there (or who enter later) suffer 2d6 damage for each space they touch.

UPCAST: +1 space, +1 damage.

TIER 5, AOE

ARCTIC BLAST 2 ACTIONS

REACH: Cone 4, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 4d6+10. This area is difficult terrain for 1 round. Any already Hampered creatures there are Restrained (frozen in place).

UPCAST: +1 Reach.

TIER 8, AOE

GLACIER STRIKE 3 ACTIONS

RANGE: 12, 3×3 AoE. **DAMAGE:** d66 bludgeoning. Creatures adjacent to that area take half as much. The entire area permanently becomes difficult terrain.

UPCAST: +1 initial area.

D66. Roll 2d6. The leftmost die is the tens place, and the second is the ones (e.g., 4 and 5 deal 45 damage).

TIER 9, AOE

ARCTIC ANNIHILATION 3 ACTIONS

REACH: 12, AoE. Any targets you choose are encased in ice and immune to damage and negative effects until the start of their next turn. All others take d66 damage, then make a STR save or be Incapacitated their next turn.

NOTE. Once you cast this spell, you must Safe Rest for 1 week before using it again.

Lightning Spells

CANTRIP

ZAP **1 ACTION**
RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 2d8. On miss: the lightning fails to find ground, and strikes you instead.

HIGH LEVELS: On hit: +4 damage every 5 levels.

CANTRIP, AOE

OVERLOAD **1 ACTION**
Castable only if Charged, ending the condition.

REACH: 2, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 2d8.

HIGH LEVELS: +4 damage every 5 levels.

CHARGED. Whenever you take lightning damage, you are Charged for 1 minute (or until combat ends).

TIER 1, 1+ TARGET

ARC LIGHTNING **2 ACTIONS**
RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 3d8. Also hits the next closest creature.

UPCAST: +4 damage.

NEXT CLOSEST CREATURE. If you are the closest, you are hit! If 2 creatures are equally close, the GM can select randomly, the taller one, or whoever has the most metal.

TIER 2

ALACRITY **0 ACTIONS**
(1/turn) Teleport up to your Speed, gain Charged (can be cast while Defending, after damage).

UPCAST: +4 spaces.

TIER 3, AOE

STORMLASH **2 ACTIONS**
LINE: 12, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 3d8+4 (ignoring metal armor) and Dazed on a failed STR save (or Incapacitated for their next turn if they fail by 5 or more). Creatures with a large amount of metal (e.g., armor or a longsword) roll with disadvantage.

UPCAST: +4 damage.

TIER 4

ELECTRICKERY **3 ACTIONS**
Castable when an ally is attacked.

RANGE: 8. They teleport away. Teleport another creature there (making them the target) on a failed WIL save. Costs **1 ACTION** if Charged, ending the condition.

UPCAST: +2 Range.

TIER 5

ELECTROCHARGE **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: 4. **CONCENTRATION:** Up to 1 min. Give a creature Charged, +1 max action, +5 Defense, 2× Speed, and advantage on DEX saves.

UPCAST: +4 Reach.

TIER 6, AOE

RIDE THE LIGHTNING **3 ACTIONS**
REACH: 12, AoE. Teleport to a spot you can see (if a willing creature is there, swap places with them). Adjacent creatures take d88 damage and are Knockedback 2 spaces. Creatures moved 2+ spaces are also knocked Prone, Dazed, and deafened for 1 day.

UPCAST: +1 Knockback.

D88. Roll 2d8. The leftmost die is the tens place, and the second is the ones (e.g., 4 and 5 deal 45 damage).

TIER 9, AOE

SEETHING STORM **3 ACTIONS**
CONCENTRATION: 1 min. Become a cloud of tempestuous storm. You can fly, move for free 1/round, and attacks against you are disadvantaged. At the end of each of your turns, strike up to 4 creatures within Reach 4 with a bolt of lightning for d88 damage (a creature can only be struck 1/round).

Costs **3 ACTIONS** each round to maintain. +2 Reach and +2 lightning bolts each round.

NOTE. Once you cast this spell, you must Safe Rest for 1 week before you can use it again.



Wind Spells



CANTRIP

RAZOR WIND **1 ACTION**
RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 1d4 slashing (Vicious). Roll with advantage or damage 1 adjacent target as well.

HIGH LEVELS: +3 damage every 5 levels.

CANTRIP

BREATH OF LIFE **1 ACTION**
RANGE: 6. Restore 1d4 HP to a Dying creature. If healed for 4+: they also regain 1 action.

HIGH LEVELS: +2 Range and healing every 5 levels.

TIER 1

BLUSTERY GALE **2 ACTIONS**
RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 3d4 bludgeoning, knockback 2 (advantage vs flying/Small/Tiny). Forced movement deals +5 damage instead of rolling additional dice.

UPCAST: +1 knockback.

TIER 2

BARRIER OF WIND **0 ACTIONS**

Castable only while Defending vs Ranged.

Ranged attacks deal half damage vs you this round.

UPCAST: Extend this effect to creatures within +1 Reach.

TIER 3

FLY **1 ACTION**
REACH: 1. **CONCENTRATION:** Up to 10 min. Grant a creature a flying Speed. They can move KEY spaces for free on their turn.

UPCAST: +1 target, +4 Reach.

SONGWEAVER ONLY, CANTRIP

VICIOUS MOCKERY **1 ACTION**
RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 1d4+INT psychic (ignoring armor). On hit: target is Taunted during their next turn.

HIGH LEVELS: +2 damage every 5 levels.

TIER 4, AOE

EYE OF THE STORM **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: 3, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 4d4+10 bludgeoning to enemies. Place surviving creatures anywhere within 1 space of the storm's Reach on a failed STR save.

UPCAST: +1 Reach.

TIER 5, AOE

UPDRAFT **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: 12, 5×5 AoE. **DAMAGE:** 20 minus a DEX save. On 10+ damage, they land Prone and Dazed.

UPCAST: +2 damage.

TIER 6, AOE

THOUSAND CUTS **3 ACTIONS**
RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** d44 with advantage. Also damages enemies within Reach 1 of your target.

UPCAST: +1 Reach.

D44 WITH ADVANTAGE. Roll 3d4 and drop the lowest die. The leftmost die is the tens place, and the second is the ones (e.g., 2, 3, and 4 deals 34 damage).

TIER 7

BOISTEROUS WINDS **2 ACTIONS**
CONCENTRATION: Up to 1 min. **REACH:** 12. You and up to 12 allies gain: Ranged attacks have disadvantage against you, a flying Speed of 12, and can move for free 1/round.

UPCAST: +1 minute or +2 targets.

Radiant Spells

CANTRIP

REBUKE **1 ACTION**
REACH: 4. **DAMAGE:** 1d6 (ignoring armor). 2× damage against undead or cowardly (those Frightened or behind Cover).

HIGH LEVELS: +2 damage every 5 levels.

CANTRIP

TRUE STRIKE **1 ACTION**
REACH: 4. A target gains advantage (ignoring all sources of disadvantage) and +1 Reach on the next melee attack they make this encounter.

HIGH LEVELS: +1 Reach every 5 levels.

TIER 1

HEAL **1 ACTION**
REACH: 1. Heal a target 1d6+KEY HP.

UPCAST: (Choose 1) +1d6, +1 target, OR +4 Reach.

POWERFUL HEALING. If 5+ mana is spent, heal a negative condition as well (e.g., Blind, 1 Wound).

TIER 2

WARDING BOND **0 ACTIONS**
CONCENTRATION: Up to 1 min. Make an ally your ward: they take half damage-2 from all attacks; you are attacked for the same amount.

UPCAST: +2 damage reduction.

TIER 3

SHIELD OF JUSTICE **0 ACTIONS**
Castable only while Defending.

Enemies who attack you this round are Blind until the end of their next turn and you deal damage back (ignoring armor) equal to damage you take.

UPCAST: +5 Damage OR +5 Defense.

TIER 4

CONDEMN **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: 4. **DAMAGE:** 30. Can only target an enemy that crit you or an ally this round. Cannot be reduced by any means. The next attack against that enemy gains advantage.

UPCAST: +1 Reach, +1 advantage.

TIER 5

VENGEANCE **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: 1. **DAMAGE:** 1d100, to a target that attacked a Dying ally or reduced one to 0 HP this round.

UPCAST: +1 Reach, roll with advantage.

TIER 6

SACRIFICE **1 ACTION**
Reduce yourself to 0 HP and you cannot have more than 0 HP until you Safe Rest.

REACH: 4. Heal an amount of HP equal to your max HP, divided as you choose to any other creatures. You may revive a creature that has died in the past minute if you give them at least 20 HP (also healing 2 Wounds from them), provided they have not been revived with this spell before.

UPCAST: +4 Reach.

TIER 9, AOE

REDEEM **1 DAY**
Requires (and consumes) a diamond worth 10,000 gp.

REACH: 1 mile. Revive any number of creatures that have died in the past year, provided they have not died of old age or been revived with this spell before.

SHEPHERD ONLY, TIER 1

 **LIFEBINDING SPIRIT** **1 ACTION**
 Summon a companion that follows you and is immune to harm. It lasts until you cast this spell again, Safe Rest, or it heals a number of times equal to the mana spent summoning it. **ACTION:** (Reach 4) It attacks for 1d6+WIL (ignoring armor), or heals for the same amount.

UPCAST: Increment its die (max d12), +1 healing use.

Necrotic Spells

CANTRIP

ENTICE **1 ACTION**
RANGE: 12. **DAMAGE:** 1d4+KEY (ignoring armor), target moves Primary Die spaces closer.

HIGH LEVELS: Increment the die size 1 step every 5 levels (d6 » d8 » d10 » d12).

CANTRIP

WITHERING TOUCH **1 ACTION**
REACH: 1. **DAMAGE:** 1d12. On damage, target is considered undead for 1 round.

HIGH LEVELS: +6 damage every 5 levels.

TIER 1

SHADOW TRAP **1 ACTION**
CONCENTRATION: Up to 1 min. **DAMAGE:** 3d12 to the next creature to move adjacent to you; if Small/Tiny, it is also Restrained for as long as you maintain Concentration or until they escape.

UPCAST: +1 size category, +1d12 damage on escape.

TIER 2

DREAD VISAGE **0 ACTIONS**
Castable only while Defending.

DAMAGE: 1d12 and Frighten all creatures attacking you in melee this round. Costs 2 mana less while dying.

UPCAST: +2 damage, +2 Defense.

TIER 3, AOE

VAMPIRIC GREED **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: 1, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 4d12. Heal HP equal to the damage dealt then gain 1 Wound. Gain 1 additional Wound for each creature that survived this damage.

UPCAST: +1 Reach OR +10 Damage.

SHADOWMANCER ONLY, CANTRIP

 **SUMMON SHADOW** **1 ACTION**
 Summon an adjacent shadow minion (max of INT or LVL summoned this way, whichever is lower). They follow the minion rules and abandon you immediately outside of combat. **1 ACTION:** (1/turn) ALL your minions move 6 then attack (Reach 1, 1d12).

HIGH LEVELS: +1 Reach every 5 levels.

TIER 4

VIGOR MORTIS **1 ACTION**
Castable only when an ally drops to 0 HP.

REACH: 8. **CONCENTRATION:** 1 min. Their max actions do not change, they skip STR saves to act, and taking damage while Dying causes 1 fewer Wounds (min 1).

UPCAST: +10 temp HP.

TIER 5, AOE

GANGRENOUS BURST **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: Up to 8, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 3d20 (ignoring armor) to damaged creatures on a failed STR save (target rolls with disadvantage if Bloodied), half on save.

UPCAST: +10 damage.

TIER 6

UNSPEAKABLE WORD **2 ACTIONS**
REACH: 8. **DAMAGE:** d66 with advantage (ignoring armor), on a failed INT save (disadvantage if Bloodied or Frightened). On a save, you both take half of this damage instead.

UPCAST: +1 DC, +10 damage.

D66 WITH ADVANTAGE. Roll 3d6 and drop the lowest die. The leftmost die is the tens place, and the second is the ones (e.g., 2, 3, and 4 deals 34 damage).

TIER 7, AOE

CREEPING DEATH **3 ACTIONS**
REACH: 8, AoE. **DAMAGE:** 4d20. If this kills the creature, repeat the damage to another creature within Reach 8 of it not yet damaged by this effect. Repeat until a target survives or no others are within Reach.

UPCAST: +10 damage.

SHADOWMANCER ONLY, CANTRIP

 **SHADOW BLAST** **1 ACTION**
RANGE: 8. **DAMAGE:** 1d12+KEY (1/round).

HIGH LEVELS: +1d12 every 5 levels.

UTILITY SPELLS

These spells are **not** learned as other cantrips; instead some classes can choose from among these additional spells as they level up.



Fire

FIRE UTILITY CANTRIP

FIREBRAND **1 ACTION**
Touch a surface and secretly mark it with a symbol or brief message. Speaking a chosen command word while nearby reveals it.

FIRE UTILITY CANTRIP

FIRE STEP **1 MINUTE**
Teleport to a fire source you can see.

FIRE UTILITY CANTRIP

KINDLE **1 ACTION**
Conjure a minor visual illusion. OR: Ignite a small, unheld item within Reach 6.



Ice

ICE UTILITY CANTRIP

CHILLCRAFT **1 ACTION**
CHILL. Harmlessly freeze, thaw, or move a bath-sized amount of water near you. OR:
CRAFT. Conjure a sheet of opaque, mirror-like, or transparent ice the size of a window or door.

ICE UTILITY CANTRIP

ICE DISK **1 MINUTE**
Conjure a floating disk of ice that follows you. It can carry moderately heavy weight for 1 hour or until you cast this spell again.

ICE UTILITY CANTRIP

WINTRY SCRYING **1 MINUTE**
Turn a small patch of water into a reflective icy mirror. Looking through it grants you vision of any desired location near this body of water for 10 min.



Lightning

LIGHTNING UTILITY CANTRIP

SPARK BUDDY **1 MINUTE**
Conjure a Tiny (squirrel-sized) helper for up to 1 hour. It can fetch Tiny objects, open unlocked doors, illuminate a small area, or deliver a harmless shock. If it takes damage or moves further than 6 spaces away from you, it dissipates into sparks.

LIGHTNING UTILITY CANTRIP

SPARK STEP **1 ACTION**
REACH: 4. Teleport to a metal object.

LIGHTNING UTILITY CANTRIP

TEMPEST'S COMMAND **1 ACTION**
Dispel a minor magical effect, or temporarily suppress a stronger one (the more powerful an enchantment, the shorter the duration). OR:
Voice of Thunder. Your eyes glow and your voice is amplified to a thunder-like volume for 1 min.



Wind

WIND UTILITY CANTRIP

WIND WHISPER **1 ACTION**
You whisper a message into the wind and it will be secretly carried to a specified target anywhere wind could reach.

WIND UTILITY CANTRIP

HELPFUL GUST **1 ACTION**
REACH: 6. Gently move a Tiny unheld item in any direction. OR: Generate an illusory scent.

WIND UTILITY CANTRIP

FEATHER FALL **1 ACTION**
REACH: 6. **REACTION:** When a creature falls, cause them to gently float to the ground.



Radiant

RADIANT UTILITY CANTRIP

LIGHT **1 ACTION**
Cause an item to brightly glow as a torch with radiant light for as long as you hold it.

RADIANT UTILITY CANTRIP

BEAUTIFY **1 ACTION**
Clean stains or repair a small tear/break in a non-magical item, or conjure tiny beautiful things: flowers, butterflies, etc.

RADIANT UTILITY CANTRIP

BOND OF PEACE **1 ACTION**
Bond. Telepathically communicate simple thoughts or feelings with a friendly creature you can see. OR: Peace. Imbue your spoken words with calming magic, granting advantage on any check made to soothe anger or fear in creatures who can hear you.



Necrotic

NECROTIC UTILITY CANTRIP

GRAVECRAFT
GRAVEMARK. Magically soil a surface with blood, filth, or other disgusting things. (**1 ACTION**)
GRAVEWORK. Shape/move a body-sized plot of earth. (**1 MINUTE**).

NECROTIC UTILITY CANTRIP

FALSE FACE **1 MINUTE**
Change your appearance to look like someone else for 10 min. Requires a piece of them.

NECROTIC UTILITY CANTRIP

THOUGHT LEECH **1 ACTION**
REACH: 6. Read the surface thoughts of a creature. They can sense you doing this and may not like it.



Optional Variant Rules

If your playgroup likes extra little tactical nuggets, your GM can allow you to try out some of these optional variants to add some more spice to your game. You can always try out a rule for 1 session before committing to it.

ALTERNATE MOVEMENT OPTIONS

Abstracted Distances. Ignore the grid (occasionally, or all the time if you prefer) using 3 range bands instead (as always, the GM will judge unclear situations and which creatures are affected by abilities with an area of effect):

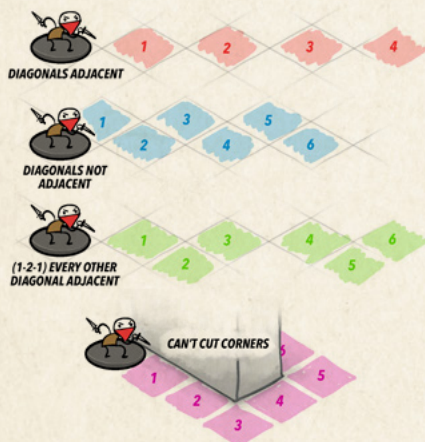
- **Close.** Creatures are effectively considered adjacent or close enough to be affected by melee attacks or abilities up to Reach/Range 3 without moving;
- **Midrange.** Creatures can be affected by thrown weapons and shorter range abilities (Reach/Range 4–6). Or you can move Close by moving once.
- **Far.** Creatures can be affected by longer range spells, bows, etc. You can move Close by moving twice.

Gridless. You can forgo counting spaces and measure typical movement from pinkie to thumb, the length of a pen or pencil, or just eyeball it—close enough is good enough for some tables!

Diagonals NOT Adjacent. This makes for more tactical combat as obstacles, allies, & enemies can strategically block movement making positioning matter much more.

Can't Cut Corners. Similar to Diagonals not adjacent, but you cannot move diagonally past walls or enemies. A good middle ground between full diagonal and non-diagonal movement.

1-2-1. Diagonal moves alternate in cost: the first one costs 1 Speed, the 2nd diagonal move in a turn costs 2, and so on.



CHARACTER CUSTOMIZATION

Simpler Characters. New players can be overwhelmed by the number of options and abilities in TRPGs—consider skipping background and even ancestry (or make it cosmetic only). Any who pick a spellcasting class like Mage, give them a smaller subset of spells to work with initially.

Complex Characters. Heroes can pick 2 backgrounds and/or ancestry bonuses.

Multiclassing. If your GM wants to allow for additional creativity for experienced players (and potentially broken combos!), when heroes level up, they may choose ANY class. For example, when a level 4 Berserker levels up, he could pick Commander, and take the level 1 Commander features instead of the level 5 Berserker features. He would have 4 d12 Hit Dice and a single d10 Hit Die. A hero gains the equipment proficiencies of all their classes but should use the advantaged/disadvantaged saves of whichever class has the highest level.

"Broken" Can Be Fun! Planning, building, optimizing, and "breaking" a class build IS the fun for many people. The GM may need to make the game substantially more challenging if multiclassing is allowed. The GM also may veto any particularly overpowered, unfun, or implausible combo for the sake of the story and overall fun of the table. If this happens, well done! Your hero was too powerful for reality.

Different Key Stats. Players can swap KEY or Secondary stats for a class if it makes sense (e.g., DEX and WIL for the Cheat).

Custom Weapon Dice. For larger weapon die sizes, you can try using dice of different sizes as long as they add up to the same initial die size. For example: a 1d10 glaive could be 1d4+1d6 or 1d6+1d4 (using the first die as the Primary Die).

Level 0 Funnels. For an old school "funnel" adventure each player gets 4 commoners to play as. Whoever survives long enough gets to become a real level 1 adventurer! Treat each as a d6 minion: no HP, no Wounds, no stats, no skills, or special abilities. On a player's turn they can move and attack with all of their commoners, and each player can Defend for 1d6 damage with a single commoner each round. If a player loses all of their commoners, you might allow them to play as a ghost which can do 1 creative thing per round (e.g., Frighten, distract, trip or possess an enemy).

HEALING & RESTING

Fast Resting. For a much more heroic and fast-paced story, 1 Safe Rest can heal all Wounds.

Mighty Healing. Regain 1 action when healed from Dying.

Critical Healing. Treat healing just like an attack roll. Rolling the max is a crit (roll again and add it to the result), rolling 1 is a failure to heal (note: this variant is FUN for the right group that enjoys big, dramatic, swingly moments). Consider incrementing the die size by one step to compensate if you use this variant (d4 » d6 » d8 » d10 » d12).

Thrown Potions. Treat potions like Ranged attacks (Range 8). The potion misses on a 1; otherwise it heals for half as much since some splashes away and is wasted.

COMBAT RULES

Boon & Bane Actions. For more tactical depth, whenever a hero gains an action, they instead gain 1 random boon, bane, or normal action (the same KEY attribute must be used for both):

- **Boon Action.** Gain advantage when rolling, +KEY Defense, or +2 Speed with this action.
- **Bane Action.** Gain disadvantage when rolling, -KEY

Defense, or -2 Speed with this action.

- **Normal Action.** Spend this action as normal.

I HAD the High Ground. Taking a crit while flying or at a height may cause a character to fall. A reasonable STR save may be called for, but a weak character (e.g., a kobold) may just fall automatically.

Sucker Punch. A Prone character standing up gives adjacent creatures the chance to take opportunity attacks (heroes and monsters alike).

Playing Dead. Whenever a Hero drops to 0 HP, they can attempt to play dead by falling Prone and making an Influence check (or other skill check as the situation demands).

Blaze of Glory. When a hero suffers their final Wound, they get 1 full turn to act before they finally die.

Retreat. The world is dangerous, and some fights may be unwinnable. Any hero may call for a retreat on their turn. If the party agrees—unless there is a good reason story-wise that a party can't

escape (e.g., they are trapped in nets and completely surrounded by a band of nasty kobolds)—the GM allows them to flee. Each hero describes their escape (e.g., casting a spell, using equipment, or making a skill check). Consequences may follow, such as taking damage, suffering a Wound, or failing a quest. If the escape is particularly clever, the GM may allow the party to escape without additional consequence. After all, the shame of retreating is often punishment enough!

Inspiration. Whenever a party or hero does something memorable (role-plays a great moment, makes everyone laugh, misses an attack multiple times in a row, or otherwise engages in positive behavior), the GM can grant Inspiration: the ability to reroll any single die. Inspiration expires after a Safe Rest.

Dramatic Leveling. Leveling up mid-combat or in another dramatic scene occasionally can make for a very memorable moment! Just make sure everyone already knows their level up choices beforehand to avoid slowing the game down.

FAQ

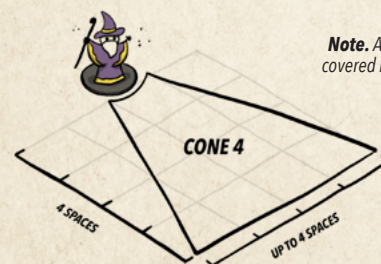
- **Defensive/Reaction Spells.** Reactions resolve before their trigger. So if an attack was made but the attacker is now Poisoned/Frightened/Blind/etc. the attack is rolled again, but taking into account the condition (rolling with disadvantage). You can only cast 1 defensive spell each time you Defend (e.g., Frost Shield OR Alacrity, not both on the same round).
- **Barrier of Wind.** When an ally is attacked at Range, if you upcast Barrier of Wind, you can Defend to protect them provided they are within Reach.
- **KEY.** Whenever a spell (or ability) uses KEY, it refers to the caster's attribute, not the target's.
- **Flat damage abilities (e.g. Condemn), or d44, d66, & d88 spells and Create an Opening?** These abilities do not have a Primary Die so they are unaffected by Create an Opening. Instead, the next attack that has a Primary Die

would be affected.

- **Interposing & AoEs?** If one can be pushed out of the affected area, AoE attacks can be Interposed.
- **How does Interposing work with conditional attacks (e.g., Troll's bite)?** If it makes sense that the hero could push their ally out of the way of the attack (e.g., the ally isn't Grappled), it works as normal—the Interposing hero suffers the damage and other effects as normal.
- **Is Grappling considered an attack?** Yes. Anything that negatively impacts your enemies is an attack and impacted by Rushed Attacks (in this case the enemy would gain stacking advantage on their save as the rushed penalty).
- **Action Cap.** Spells/Abilities like Heart's Fire and Electrocharge can bring you above your normal action cap.
- **Warding Bond.** Yes, this counts as being attacked so you can Defend against it as normal.

Measuring AoEs

Cones. Start at the character and extend X spaces outward. The cone can be up to X spaces wide at the farthest edge (you can make it narrower than X, but not wider).



Note. A space at least halfway covered is included in the effect.

Lines. Starting from the character, extend the area up to X spaces in a single direction (you can make it shorter, but not longer), and 1 space wide.



Glossary

Advantage X. Roll X additional dice and drop the X lowest dice (removing dice from the left to right in the case of a tie).

Ally. A friendly creature, not yourself.

AoE. (Area of Effect). Special attacks that target an area rather than individual creatures (see *"Reach, Range, & AoEs"* on pg. 10).

Assess. An action to strategically analyze the situation in combat (see *"Assess"* on pg. 13).

Attack. Any offensive action. Swinging with a weapon, casting a harmful spell, Grappling, etc.

Basic Attack. A cantrip or weapon attack.

Blind. Can't see. Attacks against you have advantage, and your attacks have disadvantage.

Blindsight X. You can sense creatures and obstacles normally within X spaces, ignoring Blind, darkness, and invisibility.

Bloodied. At half HP or less.

Burrowing. When a creature can move normally underground.

Cantrip. A basic spell. Costs 0 mana to cast, and their power increases as you level up.

Charged. Some spells/abilities have additional effects when Charged (e.g., Overload, Electricity). Become Charged whenever you take lightning damage. Lasts 1 min or until combat ends.

Charmed. Sees the charmer as an ally. Charmer has advantage on social interactions with you.

Climbing. A creature with a climbing Speed can move across vertical surfaces as flat ground, otherwise climbing is treated as Difficult Terrain.

Concentration. Can only Concentrate on 1 thing at a time. DC 10 STR save when crit or it breaks (see *"Concentration"* on pg. 8).

Cone X. Starts at the character and extends X spaces outward, becoming up to X spaces wide at the farthest edge.

Cover. If mostly obscured, incoming attacks have disadvantage. If completely obscured (Full Cover), cannot typically be targeted.

Crit. Whenever a creature rolls the max on a Primary Die, that die is rolled again and added to the total.

d44, d66, d88. Roll 2 of the same dice, the left-most die is the tens place, and the second is the ones. These attacks do not miss or crit.

Damage Types. Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing, Fire, Cold, Lightning, Radiant, Necrotic, and Psychic. Heroes typically do not care what type of damage they take, but some monsters or environmental challenges do.

Darkvision X. Can see normally in the dark, up to X spaces.

Dazed. Heroes: lose 1 action; monsters: can perform one less action on their next turn.

Decrement/Increment. Use a die one size smaller or larger (d4 > d6 > d8 > d10 > d12 > d20).

Difficult Terrain. Speed halved while here.

Disadvantage X. Roll X additional dice and drop the X highest dice (removing dice from the

left to right in the case of a tie).

Distracted. A target is distracted if it is adjacent to or Taunted by an ally, or if it cannot see you.

Dying. When a hero is at 0 HP (see *"Hit Points & Dying"* on pg. 9).

Encounter. An encounter begins when Initiative is rolled and ends when hostilities do.

Falling. Suffer 1d6 damage/2 spaces fallen.

Field Rest/Safe Rest. Spend time to recover some of your resources (see *"Resting & Downtime"* on pg. 16).

Free. Does not cost an action or any other resource (e.g., mana) unless otherwise stated.

Frightened. Disadvantage on rolls when source of fear is near; Speed halved when moving closer to it.

Grappled. Cannot move. Attacks against you have advantage (see *"Grappling"* on pg. 10).

Hampered. Any creature with actions or movement reduced (e.g., Dazed, Grappled/Restrained, Prone, Slowed, in Difficult Terrain).

Incapacitated. Can't do anything. Attacks against you have advantage, and melee attacks that hit, crit.

Invisible. Cannot be seen. Your attacks have advantage, and attacks against you have disadvantage.

KEY. The two most important stats for a class. Replace with either of your KEY attributes.

Knockback/Push X. Forcefully move a creature X spaces, ignoring Difficult Terrain. Other creatures or the environment may halt movement prematurely and deal damage (see *"Falling & Forced Movement"* on pg. 10).

Line X. A straight line extending up to X spaces in one direction.

LVL. Level. When part of an attack, replace it with the character's level.

Mana. Used to fuel spellcasting (see *"Magic"* on pg. 44). See the individual Hero classes for more info on how they gain mana.

Minion. Simple creatures: any damage kills them; each attacks with a single damage die, cannot crit, and misses on a roll of 1; when multiple minions attack a single target, their damage is combined and counts as a single attack

Move X. Move up to that many spaces.

Paralyzed, Stunned, Unconscious. Incapacitated. Can't do anything. Attacks against you have advantage, and melee attacks that hit, crit.

Petrified. Incapacitated with all the benefits and drawbacks of being a rock! Immune to most damage except from large explosions, picks, or similar tools.

Poisoned. Disadvantage on rolls (typically, healing ends).

Primary Die. The leftmost die in an attack, this die determines if an attack misses or crits.

Prone. Movement costs twice as much, and disadvantage on attacks. Melee attacks against you have advantage; Ranged have disadvantage. Spend 3 spaces of your Speed to stand up.

Range X. Ranged attacks are made with disadvantage if ANY enemy is adjacent. Range can be extended (see *"Reach, Range, & AoEs"* on pg. 10).

Reach X. The area within X spaces around a character; forming your choice of a cube or sphere.

Resistance. Take -10 damage vs a specific damage type.

Restrained. (Same as Grappled; objects Restrained, creatures Grapple) Cannot move. Attacks against you have advantage.

Riding. You move with the creature you are riding. Any attacks that miss you, strike them (see *"Grappling"* on pg. 10).

Round. The time in combat when each Hero and enemy has a chance to act (see *"Turns, Rounds, & Encounters"* on pg. 15).

Rushed Attacks. Attacking more than once on a turn imposes a cumulative disadvantage penalty (e.g., attacking with a short sword for the third time on a turn, you would roll 3d6 and take the lowest result).

Silenced. Cannot cast spells or use other abilities that require speaking (e.g. Commander's Orders).

Skill Points. Use them to increase your skills. Start with 4 at level 1 and gain 1 each level (see *"Leveling Up"* on pg. 21).

Slowed. Speed halved during your next turn.

Smoldering. This condition does nothing on its own, though some spells and abilities have additional effects against Smoldering creatures, ending the condition (e.g., Ignite, Pyroclasm).

Spellcasting Focus. Can be used instead of an empty hand to cast spells.

Stats. STR, DEX, INT, WIL: the core attributes of a character.

Surprise. When combat starts before all sides are aware (see *"Starting Combat"* on pg. 15).

Target. A selected creature or object. It must be within Range/Reach and able to be sensed.

Taunted. Disadvantage on attacks except against the most recent taunter.

Teleport. Move instantaneously. Does not provoke opportunity attacks.

Temp HP. HP that do not replenish (see *"Hit Points & Dying"* on pg. 9).

Turn. The primary time allotted for an individual hero or monster group to act.

Unheld. Not touched, worn, or held by anyone.

Upcast. Spend extra mana on a spell to gain an extra effect for each additional mana spent.

Vicious. Roll 1 additional die whenever you roll crit damage.

Vulnerable. When a creature is vulnerable to a damage type, it takes +10 damage.

Wound. A measure of how close a hero is to death. Typically 6 and you're dead (see *"Hit Points & Dying"* on pg. 9).

Wounded. Has any Wounds.